Creative director 101: brief and techniques

in this video we're going to cover creative Direction 101 we're going to talk about building creative briefs and how to do those so that they work we're going to talk a bit about the creative process if you're generating a lot of assets and we're going to talk about how creative Direction applies to things like making products interesting and creating ads and this is a good topic because the term creative directors has become very widely used but really in theory it's about how do you make things interesting and how do you tie all the pieces of the cultural conversation that are happening into decisions that you make inside product marketing and branding all with the through line of design so I've got a bunch of interesting examples and things to talk through everything from some products some standout product direction from things like this dreze fragrance set we'll talk about I'm going to be unboxing some new product samples and talking about the creative Direction there I have a products I just got I was super stoked on it's an awesome example of applying some creative strategy to product and I'm actually going to walk through a bunch of the creative I've been making with the design team dark room I work with for my own brand you can see the briefing process you can see the creative that comes out of it and you can see how designers and creative directors of Brands can work together in a rhythm but most importantly we're actually going to Zone in on a couple key creative Direction strategies so you begin to build a toolkit that you can use for Creative Direction no matter what your field is if you're a designer videographer a marketer an entrepreneur you can begin to look at these options and say Here's how I make things stand out so without further Ado let's do it so I'm going to dive right into the value first and I'm going to talk about creative Direction strategies so I like to think of almost every creative as someone who needs a toolkit I made a previous video about this about organizing and strategizing on your creative toolkit but really it's about including techniques things you can do on any given campaign or product to make your stuff hit and as a creative director I built out my toolkit over time I've used it as a CMO as a VP of marketing as a product designer as a consultant in all kinds of different roles I have a number of things that I go to recurringly to look at is this how I can make this thing or that thing stand out we're going to walk through them exactly so one of the easiest ones is the idea of scale you can make almost anything inherently more interesting by making it really big or really small and all these I'm going to talk about are Concepts you can apply to your reference cuz we have all these videos about mood boarding or building up references people build all these big boards but what do you do with it how do you make it original you take your reference and you go through your toolkit and look at what you can apply to make it different so for scale and I've talked about this one I believe before and I've done some short form videos on it this is something that Brands like Jacamo use all the time you see them use scale inside their social media content they make really big objects and that is just a technique that is attention grabbing on camera but then something really small by virtue is almost the same can you make the really cute version of something that exists already and after scale comes aesthetic so for instance if your brand is a really strong aesthetic and if you have a creative Direction angle to your brand you probably want to develop that aesthetic ahead of time and by aesthetic I mean Western Gothic a commonly known visual theme that ties all your things together you can apply that aesthetic lens to any referencer idea you can take a photo from a famous campaign and be like hey let's do take the Western angle let's take our aesthetic approach to this can we do the same setup but within our world of being built can we do it if it's Gothic brand like it's in all black has these fonts and these treatments but it's this concept we put on our mood board so applying your aesthetic can

become the toolkit and this is different from the idea of beauty which I'll get to now where you take any existing idea and you drive it up a notch by saying how do we make it as aesthetically pleasing as humanly possible this is an angle I'm going to unbox some luggage here in a minute that a brand I really enjoy took with one of their products and use it as an example and then we have the idea of Transportation it's not the best word for it but you'll understand the concept when I break it down how can you take a reference or take an idea and put it in a completely foreign place this idea of having a runway show in the Mojave Desert or showing off a car on a glacier these are things you see commonly in advertised things will be almost in a completely surreal environment and by moving what's expected into somewhere unexpected you immediately Engage The viewers mind they know something's not quite right and they're intrigued and then one of my favorite is is this idea of clashing how do you take two ideas and hit them together as hard even if they don't quite work there's something happening and this works great if you have a bunch of references on your mood board and you say I'm going to combine two things to make something completely new where you can take an angle or a composition of something you love from one photo or one video set but then combine it with a specific look or feel or setting or setup that you have somewhere else that brings it into this new thing this is one of the easiest ones for people to digest when you do build these big mood boards you can go here's all the things we like how do we not just copy them okay let's take X from this one let's take y from this one and then really ask yourself does that stand out and we'll talk a bit about that line in some of the examples I'm going to walk through and then we have tension how can you apply an emotion that makes people feel a little bit odd to any anything that you're Crea shame fear anger ego and I'm not saying this is the most moral way to go about them if someone looks at something and they feel bad about themselves then you are creating a feeling if someone looks at it and they feel great they feel supported in their beliefs even if they may feel weird about their beliefs something that they've had tucked away it's applying their ego that's an idea fear obviously a big component in marketing and any home security system how can you make them feel that inside any campaign or anything that you do all these are tools that you have to take the ordinary and make them extraordinary and the more them you understand and list out and begin to experiment with and try the farther you go inside whatever you're putting together so on that note I'm actually talk through a few products and just give a few examples and I'm going to dive into some figma boards and show some work so first I want to talk about this semi viral Dre van noton fragrance set the card that they have inside they these gorgeous luxury per and it is somewhat viral because I ripped this one up so I'm holding it patched together a bit they have this fragrance kit that just looks extremely be it's a set it has that unique social friendly looking feel and you see all these color patterns running behind it what I want to call out here is that this is a pretty pretty much a normal perfume sampler to seen a thousand like it maybe a slight alternative of Capper variety and when I rip open this packaging you see that the only thing that's behind it is a literal gloss print card and it's getting this effective presentation so this is one I love to call out as an example because they're using the beauty angle they said Hey how do you take a normal fragrance sampler how do you make it something aesthetically pleasing but also everyone talks about what is the cost and obviously there's a ton of cost involved in any ornate perfume packaging a huge part of that industry this is a literal paper box die cut to fit these in there with a another piece of printed paper like literally printed behind it with a color pattern on it this is not an expensive piece of packaging for this set especially for what they charge with it and then all this set just basically being a down sell to get you to then go buy the $230 bottle this is just created with intention someone said how do we take this and

apply Beauty to it and then found a way to do that all right so next up we are going to be unboxing some luggage this is from July they are an Australian luggage brand they sell in the US their claim to fame is truck they sell all kinds of regular luggage for people like the TRS but I don't know if y'all have seen that uh there's the meme of what's his name the guy from 30 Seconds to Mars Jared Le and he's at a Gucci runway show and he sees someone walk by in the outfit and his like Jaw is dropped down and then he's wearing the outfit like 3 months later that was me with this suitcase because I've begun to look at things like all right I can have any standard thing I can have a raoa I can have things that look a certain way but when you're making content you begin to think about what's going to help a video Hit what are all those little things that could even just the ownership of it could potentially make anyone hang on for an extra half a second in a video what can make a photo pop and then when you're in a category that's as old as luggage and as competitive where there's a 100 brands if you follow me on Instagram you know I do a series called Product versus brand where I talk about luggage Brands and break them down and there's a 100 luggage Brands many of which are mediocre and so July had a standout form factor but they also then applied a standout aesthetic so this is a gloss trunk trunk in a normal carry-on size but the gloss impact of this and when I saw in the ad I had that same effect of like ooh like what about that in multiple colors it's just an aesthetic choice that no one else is doing everything you see out there is Matt is subtle this is decidedly unsettle really stand out has a number of colors if you don't want to go full Supreme red I got the green one as well that's like an emerald green but they're saying hey we're going to take the beauty angle in product with a simple technique that just stands out in the market it positions against everyone's subtle base colors and goes that is super bright while still incorporating their trademark trunk Style so it already has an aesthetic difference that the brand has with this beauty angle applied on top and even if you they offer this in your regular matte colors too if this is too much which will be for a ton of people then the downsell is it's getting people to look at the mat options they present them side by side in the advertisement with they kind of natural contrast and a little an option based for your personality type so then next up you may have seen I've been wearing these online a bit this is a sample for my valuables brand for 2025 it's a set of baggy cargo pants that we are doing in this super unique textured fa that you've probably seen in my videos so I've been thinking about content I'm going to do for that I'll bring this up inside the the figma that we're going to show in a minute but it's like all right how do I make content around samples for my brand because I've noticed as I've been running this brand that I need to be building more hype for the products before they come out I've never been a big like hype up the drop person I like to put things out and then sell them but as a social media Creator and thinking more from that angle as thinking from a brand perspective I need to story tell better and so part of what I wanted to do for all the new things I'm creating is document the sample Journey more so then my thought is how do I cretive direct that cuz I can sit here here and be like I'm or this is the sample I made it's this and it's this and it's this how do I apply an interesting angle to that and so you'll see we came up with this idea uh two ideas really where we're going to make like almost like a carousel that documents the process of it that's presented in our in a very aesthetic way and then a video that goes with that in a complimentary aesthetic where it builds like an archive basically where I am instead of just talking through the sample I'm talking through an archive I'm going valuable sample 2025 003 the blank blank blank it's doing to this it's in this status and then we're you know these are the changes that are going to be made before it goes like live and like kind of and then having as a record and then having a directory of all these things as they come alive and then doing that in a carousel format in a video format and seeing what works but that's

me taking a common idea and then applying just a visual concept on top of it that matches the aesthetic of my brand and then the the last thing I'm going to talk about before we get into some screen sharing is this sample which I haven't even opened which is from shift Global who are producing a back FR and this is going to be a conversation about creative Direction technique this is where just showing the frame of mind that goes into so there's two types of products right you can make a product just that looks One Way Or you make a product that has some sort of interesting function and then obviously in the best world you do both so far in the products I've created I've just done a lot of things t-shirts with cool designs on them they're elevated in various ways but I also want to make things I think have the potential to be more important more interesting in someone's workflow so this is a vintage duffel bag that that shift has sampled they did the design with me they did all the technicals and stuff they're excellent at it we worked on Concepts together you'll notice the important thing about this product is this right here the zipper angle so this idea is that we are able to use this to put a full pair of shoes in and not touch anything else in the bag that's what we're going to test out in the sample said hey if you want to carry shoes in your bag we now have a whole section of this and you have a really nice luxury carry all you can carry around with this unique vintage feel you can see what we did with this leather here which is excellent like in these straps custom zippers a valuable tag to make something really interesting obviously these on the bottom but that's making a user choice plus the visual aesthetic we have of the brand so whenever I go to create anything you really want to think through like what is that user journey of it how can we make this really applicable I know that the majority of dudes are just throwing shoes in their bag and that's probably not the best decision let's give them an easy way to do that let's also make something so super social media friendly where anyone that owns this they want to make a video and unzip this and pull their shoes out they have something unique and then I'll tease this in a minute to we're looking at like over the shoulder bag that fits a full laptop inside there as well that's our quick product unbox pop onto the computer all right CH let's actually dive into some workflow here so for my brand I do a lot of graphics with an agency called dark room they have a service called Dark Art that I have a designer through it's a couple thousand bucks a month but the biggest thing they have and the reason I use them is their designers have taste and are like trained appropriately to their standards and they do ads for like all these brands that that you would know we'll dive a bit into the actual workflow here so here you'll see this is a notion where we actually create the stuff that we so there's an in progress folder these are stuff we're working on now there's a completed an archive folder every time I want to make something new inside of this in notion make a new page populate a potential due date what style request it is what the number of assets that I need are Etc and I fill in a brief so for instance this is a brief type this one I just put in for these sample videos a brief title the add type the purpose number of assets the ratios links to the content they're going to use and any other info and then a bunch of the reference so then that gets put into the pipeline for people to work on and so I'll call out that this is basically the format that you need if you're communicating with somebody you need a way to give them a brief has all the things that they need to know that you can then add lines to based on your workflow this is the one I have with these guys through notion the last uh brand I was at was I was the svpm marketing I had about an eight person team doing this kind of stuff we did it in clickup there was an intake form there's a form that would go in and we get ided to designers cues and we had a view of where everything was everyone could look at and people from other departments could request those assets I could approve whether it would be done or not and we could work through things like that and we could put our own in there and everyone put

their tasks in there as well so we could see one holistic system you can do that notion you can do that in Click up you can do that in the day I prefer notion for a number of reasons I have a lot of other workflow in here Etc but I would basically include the title of the brief the creative type what the ask is number of assets you need where it's going the ratios the exact content people people make sure they put the links and stuff in any references they have this is creative brief 101 and so there's a more nuanced like you know interesting stuff you can do when you really get into it but like that's the core that but with that comes references and how you do refer I'm going to pop over here to Pinterest so I have a shared Pinterest board with the designers on the proess we're looking at references of things that we want to try we think are interesting it's like okay how could we pull something like this together like all these different ads like for instance you'll see when I open up the emails we actually did something like this but a magazine I have a lot of white background assets this is just looking at different ways you could use them and deploy them we have a bunch of these in here for conversation at all times if you saw my video the other week um where I was showing how I use artless stuff um this is kind of example reference I've used for video but it's important to keep these and use them both ways because I brief the designers to work on specific design but I also brief photographers whenever we're doing a shoot so this reference is something the designer put in there he wants to do something like this when I go to make the brief for the next photo shoot for shoes I'm going to put this in there and be like hey please capture every angle I would need to get this kind of photo or to do this kind of design he's going to get their angles they may put their own twist on it may have a conversation about it but then that will go over the designer and they'll have the assets they need this kind of flow is really important to keep the conversation going and then if you get in a real workflow where your designer and your photo folks Etc and you are all on the same board and you can really start to cook but it's also totally fine to keep it like I have my photo team and I have the design team kind of separate and you can see we do a lot of print ads and print ad Styles and so we have a lot of those kind of variants in here different things we look at you'll see we have something based on this is a piece of creative we're working on now you need to have a place that you can go to whenever you want something new and you don't have an idea let's actually go through and talk to some of those references and you can look at at and you can say all right how do we make this kind of unique to us right how do we apply our brand kit to it how do we apply those principles I mentioned before about tension or scale how do we just use those visuals in our own so after briefs are in after references are pulled then we're going over into the actual design so for instance this is a email segment in here we have our email kit so this what I mean by a basis or a kit is this is all the things we use for emails the fonts we use this is the sizes this is the buttons this is the styles that we use all easily referenceable so if we decide to change them we can change them in one place and update and you'll see like that book I just mentioned we're using like a m Magazine version of that here this is more interesting than like a default product photo like this to have it be like a magazine shot with some of the sketches I have so this is how we kind of take that idea and apply it into our own brand and what we're creating and the designer will be able to look at and say hey I pulled this from this reference like sometimes I'll include a reference in the brief sometimes I'll just be like whatever ideas you have and they'll go back to those shared boards and pull things with their own inspiration that they know we've agreed on and you'll see how those emails will come alive you similar you saw this other graphic treatments in there we've applied our own styles to this so let's talk about stuff that's in process so for instance I want to make those sample character cells I mentioned before I dropped in a bunch of kind of options and variants and Graphics was like Hey I want to think about this

and we we jumped into a process for it where I said hey I want to instead of just having a picture of a sample I throw on some concrete let's make something let's so we took some of these sticker Graphics something that we kind of worked on prior something we created for the brands we have some elements we could use on different things okay like hey how can we throw that in let's list out some key items for it let's design a timeline of where the product is at in like the design and creation stage we can then call do a call out for on where it is potential graphic treatments these like kind of C pieces here we're pulling something together live from this idea of like how do we make a more interesting sample Carousel another one you'll see this complex con invite that we did pull up that brief so this was one where I saw this graphic which I'm pretty sure is like AI or whatever I was like cool this would be actually interesting back to like that Transportation idea like let's put a real person inside because I have a model shot in a very similar pose and let's actually put the clothing items in there so I listed out he let's put the cap let's put the sneakers let's put the bag we actually have all of our stickers like I mentioned before and so we created this as the invite and it's like boom the person's in there so it's immediately like different kind of intriguing and people like oh you're making an action figure and then I have all these items that are in there we have the stickers and that became the invite for the event but then taking it a step further into like the scale concept I mentioned earlier is like one of these comments here is me being like how big could this go because I'm thinking hey maybe we put this as a 10t print out like on the booth let's apply scale to this idea cuz people really liked it or maybe I could get like a plastic blister pack thing like this and it could actually be a photo opportunity like that's where you begin to get that process going where you have that toolkit and say oh could I make a really big version of this for future events or hey people like this what else can we do and incorporate from it and you begin to see everything from hey those sticker designs make it into everything to hey maybe we use this action figure concept you place it somewhere else in there you begin to build a bit of a world and another kind of thing to think about here is ADS like if you are running ads you need ton of them I'm putting new stuff into ASC uh all the time on meta and one of the things I saw another YouTuber you may know um Dar or Dara I'm not sure I've met her in person but um she makes YouTube about about ads and Facebook ads and she had a a real like hey you be try and call out ads and so I was like cool I put that reel as the brief and was like and I put the call outs for a bunch of my products in there and they tried it out with some different styles like this color range that we have that we've had before we did these kind of like almost like vintage ad like oversized style as well um again with our our kind of background in these different sizes you can see how this ties to some of the other similar stuff that we have and then this kind of newer looking feel here for these and that's stuff that I'm immedately going to test and I'm going to drop into the Facebook campaigns but you have to have that flow of like we need new ads we need new Concepts so if I see a video I'm popping it in as a brief if I see something on Pinterest or Arena or whatever I'm saving it in the shared folder and I'm using that for a brief whenever we have it but build up your references put a ton of stuff into briefs you get it you test it based on what works you do more these call out ads work then we'll try new visual Styles we'll try new products we'll build this out as you can see it's already got a bunch of options but we'll add more into what you know we can actually put together but this is the idea of briefing in workflow and revisions and application that is the basics of applying intention and direction to what you're creating and the same exact thing works with when you're creating content you're creating reals or whatever when you're in product devel when you're in design development when you in UI it's just a good example that I have that I'm allowed to show so anyway hope you found that interesting this is kind of the 101 version of creative Direction

and how to do briefs I'm going to do a more advanced version of this I'm thinking of doing that with a guest and someone who like lives and breathes inside briefing um that probably doing the new year and I'm definitely have more creative Direction videos one of the ones I'm working on putting together is actually pulling a bunch of like different creative directors their portfolios and their work to like just show through a big archive the way I did that like 100 Art Direction references video um I did just do an art Direction 101 video like the other week it's easy to hunt down it's very similar probably link it here at the end um that just thinks about that perspective but I'm trying to make sure as many of y'all as possible just get that basics of like there's no schools that teach this right uh you basically learn on the job or you don't like all right how does the briefing process work how do I use references what are techniques I can do what is a real life workflow um and to show as much of that as possible so I appreciate youall watching um my hyper newsletter mail. hyper studios. us talks about brand strategy and creative direction if you want to sign up for that I have a bunch of products for sale valuable studios.com um as always like And subscribe and appreciate appreciate y'all so much

The Art Direction of Modern Streetwear

In this video, I'm going to talk about the art direction and content playbook for modern street wear. I'm stoked to make this video because streetear is at a crossroads. We move from the Supreme Generation Palace world of crossover of street wear and luxury to the Instagram and Tik Tok world and the rise of Instagram and Tik Tok brands and brands that dominate off of content. Content is better than ever. Designs are better than ever. And anyone that's trying to make quick money, which is an absolute joke to even say in clothing, or who isn't amazing with their designs and marketing and community, is going to get wiped out. Only the fittest, the best are going to survive this next 18 months in the brand building world. Cuz frankly, everyone can make something amazing. This is a shirt from like I think it's a candle brand that's just like their merch included that has as good of a wash and a feel as like 70% of streetear brands. Like the standard now is so high for success in such a competitive world that it's actually forcing brands to do really interesting stuff and really push the limits in a way that I quite enjoy. So I'm going to cover 10 brands here and we are going to discuss their strategy and notes and I'm going to break down a playbook for brands covering everything you need to know and have on the radar for creative strategy for apparel. And just a quick heads up, I have a strategy toolkit. It's free. It is linked below in the description. It says content ideas for teasers, unveils, launches, like all in an organized database. This is what I use when I do creative strategy on apparel projects. You can grab that for free in the description. Let's lock in. But first, we're going to talk about one of my favorite brands, a brand you've seen me wear extensively on YouTube and Tik Tok, dating back years now, preceding their takeover, and that is House of Errors. And I want to talk about House of Errors because they are a brand that truly embodies the power of art direction. This is a photographydriven brand. Now, a combination of photography and videography, but especially in the beginning, the power of their visual images combined with the standout nature of the items gave us something that is unlike what anyone had ever really seen. And I like to use them as an example. When people were talking about photos or campaigns for their brands, I feel like this is the standard. Like this shoot with these massive faces was pretty early on inside the brand's journey. The one that really uh brought them some significant exposure was this Black Friday market crash shoot launched on Black Friday. They are recreating um some kind of famous scenes here. The photography is amazing. The

casting is amazing. The way it shows the clothes is amazing. They've played with perspective and scale in shoots like this. More abstract lookbooks and incredible scenarios. Recreating a famous Zedane scene here. Every single one of these shoots is incredible. And I look to any brand and I'm like, "Hey, if you really want to go into street wear right now, are you hitting at this level? Are is your creative for stills hitting at this level?" Because that is the threshold. This was a new brand that came out of nowhere that is now regarded on a level of any kind of major streetear brand. And when it comes to art direction, the concepts of the shoe, the execution of them, and what we see there, I feel like this is what you need to be looking for where every single thing has a unique House of Errors feel. It has a concept to it. We see everything from the old or models in here. And I'm not saying these aren't these are uh certainly thought through and they spent some money on them, but this isn't like this is completely crazy either. But this is the playbook for one of the most interesting brands. Also shows purely by the building of this universe combined with the unique element of the clothing, you can stand out. But now I want to talk about a brand that I bring up a lot when people talk about creative concepts for content. Especially when clothing brands look at content, they go, "Cool, I'm just going to shoot some more stuff on the concrete background or whatever it is." They are an example of a brand that has used virality to their advantage. You can go viral on social media making content for your streetear brand and they are an amazing example of it. So much so that they've been duplicated a hundred times. I'm going to leave with this video. This is the stop and frisk video that did so well it became a trend where people basically this guy gets arrested in front of a glass screen and it is a fit check for the actual brand products. Absolute destruction. Incredible video. Again, I'm not going to speak to I think a difference between a brand like this and my house of errors is that the clothes are much better on a house of errors. But the creative is excellent enough here. They've been able to break through and become part of the conversation by the quality of the videos. And you will notice that they would much rather have an amazing conceptual video that's executed than have a dozen quick little Tik Tok videos. Every reel that you have on here, from what we've just seen, again, another variation on the stop and frisk meme to that explosion pan back and forth. They are relentless in the conceptual execution of everything that they do. And I think when any brand goes on a shoot now, when you're going into a video shoot, you need to be thinking how are you executing on that level. If you're not coming with those ideas, like don't do the shoot. But not every brand succeeds purely on creative. So one I want to call out is Lwood. Probably been inundated with Lwood ads or know Lwood know the name Lwood. So Lwood's organic content doesn't do well. You can tell a lot of these just by the like ratio, right? Like uh some do good, some do don't, but the majority of their best content is run as ads in Spark ads and Instagram ads. They create content for ads and this is not a bad thing. This is a good technique that people can do. This is a technique that uh Cole Buckton represent. A lot of people have ran their organic stuff as ads. So common most brands do, but they've just made a whole industry around it saying, "Hey, if we make a fit check walkthrough, we don't care how it works on organic. We are going to run that same concept as an ad and run 100 variations on it." And you can see this has 530 hearts, right? And hundred thousands of views because it works as an ad. And so they are saying it doesn't m organic distribution doesn't matter. Spark ads, Tik Tok ads, meta ads are cheap enough that if we make a lot of this creative in a way that we feel sells it, our best bet to get it in front of people is going to be doing it through advertising. And they do a wide variety of it from these kind of compilation videos to the actual uh creative directors and people like that walking through the difference between their TE's. They are just designing advertising to look like their organic videos and putting personalities on camera to show off

the clothes. And I think for a company, especially a company like this where if you buy into Lwood, it becomes your core tea or your core sweat or you get one, they're banking on lifetime value, right? They're like, "Cool, we drop new colors, you're picking up more." They make a very stylable wardrobe that accentuates the existing clothes you have. This is a brand that is built less around statement pieces and more around everything else in your wardrobe. And if you're going to market something like that, they're doing a good job for you. And they've added vintage. That's an interesting thing about that, too. They're basically doing curated thrifting on top of that. But again, these are they are focused on this elevated basics, for lack of a better term, but how to sell those isn't trying to go organic on the feed. Going viral with elevated basics is going to be a particularly hard thing. Even just having a good organic presence, but making good content that sells via ads, they've nailed it. And so, quick notes on that. I've run a lot of ads on apparel brands. As many of you know, I've worked for years and years now as a partner in the awesome understated leather. It's a women's brand. I have my own small valuables brands we're slowly building. I wish I could spend like 10x more time on, but frankly, content and business is more lucrative. I have spent even that brand everything we do is based on like success in meta ads when it comes to online you can get organic organic is just fuel for that you have a great organic post it's really that to me is just an ability for me to run great ads on multiple platforms and I can't speak enough to the potential for brands to really look at their content holistically like that when they're doing those campaigns and the total available market they have when you are doing multiple platforms multiple content types and you're doing organic plus paid you can have nice little businesses that don't even appear to be big uh and that is a secret to this but it all comes back do amazing editorial and amazing content that's thought through and then executed. And I like to call out those brands. I feel like they're on the up and up. House of I think is just getting started. Cold Culture, I think, has cracked the code for a minute on how to get this viral attention. I'm curious to see what they do. Elwood, I think, is an underrated kind of money printer. They're probably doing a lot of sales. They're now on YouTube. They're obviously trying to do some interesting things. I know they worked on Paige Lorenz's brand, Dairy Boy, and a few other they've got their hands in stuff. I think they have the right entrepreneur mentality to go much wider, even though they are disparaged heavily online pretty frequently. So I think they are like headed towards more interesting things as well. Obviously the vintage launch like they're making moves. But then there's brands I feel like are kind of not making moves. So So uh and maybe like we've ended that time. So Aly is one of those where they uh did a really impressive thing where they basically built a luxury brand out of nothing. Just not an easy thing to do. High price points, high quality, high perception. And then some of these things like the recurring environments, recurring characters, the same models inside the the things that they do. You see these recurring themes and motifs executed at a really high level, but they're still pretty simple when it all comes down to it, but it's perfectly curated, perfectly well done. I think it is very hard for a brand to come out and do this in in our our era currently at the same level. The quality of the clothing, the quality of the art direction, the content they did, the premium price point, and this look and feel, I feel like brands like this and about blank just kind of like a cheaper version in its own way where it's very image focused. It's very straightforward. let the garment speak for themselves, like speak to a more luxury environment. That period is kind of over and a lot of it's over because of the nature of who the customer is for this, right? This is a product for guys uh you like junior people at Goldman Sachs, people that are in bank, it's a like a negative status signaler when people like or have something like this, the more you see their customer base like tech bros, you realize who the our direction of that kind of thing

really speaks to. Now, you can make plenty of money with that as a brand. There's always that difference within fashion culture of like what actually resonates and has a longevity of being able to be cool to people for a really really long time. What makes the sales and the interaction that I think is an interesting play about blank is the same thing less so on the customerbased conversation but they make very simple content and simple art direction. It really stood out because of its quality and simplicity when they launched but if you tried to recreate that playbook now like you would basically fail horribly and you can watch them they are just now starting to pivot a bit of their playbook to more outside shoots. They even integrated a little bit of video. They took the longest time before starting to introduce those vignettes and they didn't have to because the brand was in a certain place. But this look and feel, the very basic photo shoot, the very detail- oriented macros, the branding on everything, this works cuz they built off of it. And I think right now it, as you can see, cuz they're pivoting some of their content into new styles is the end of that era. That is not a strategy that continues to work. I think we need to be really conscious of like the eras you're in from content consumption. There's an era people really wanted elevated and clean and that to come from independent brands. And for a moment, I want to talk about Satoshi Nakamoto for a moment. Um, this is a brand I was at in Complex Con. My booth was somewhere near theirs and they had the uh I forget what it's called, the cage of death or whatever it is where it's like the motorcycle riders can ride around inside of it. They're a brand who has thoughts about positioning extremely in-depth. Their photography is good. Everything they do is like solid um but not life-changing. The designs are good, but this is a positioning brand. This brand succeeds because of the name. It's probably one of the smartest branding plays I've seen in this last decade. They saw this cultural thing with what's happening with Bitcoin. The name is Toshi Nakamoto. Japanese brand and they say, "Hey, cool. This is positioning to a signaler to people that really know. We can bring credibility to it as a Japanese brand and we can execute something at a luxury level at a luxury cost and price point that speaks to this counterculture to this, you know, Mr. Robot Bitcoin streetear lifestyle. They've executed on that just absolutely excellently. But if their name was something else, they wouldn't be a fraction of the success of what that is." And it's a good thing to call out when you look at a brand has to kind of have everything. You have to have the quality and interest of the clothes and clothes for a brand like this kind of have to be loud to get that that name out there. You have to have the art direction. They're doing really interesting photos and stuff here. It's not really popping on social media, but it's again it's a job of a brand like this is to be more of a signaler brand where it may even be a detractor for them to make really big content on social media cuz it's one of those like if you know you know and the name nods to that as well. But there those are kind of like once in a decade once in a fiveyear opportunities to act on something like this. And so if you do, if you have an idea of that caliber or that level or that social resonance, I cannot speak highly enough to uh trying to act on it and they've done great work. This week's video is brought to you by Musicbed. As always, I'm going to make these sponsors educational. And so today, we're going to talk about sounds. Music Bed just added sounds into their platform. And I'm going to walk through a few that you should definitely know that can help elevate your short form content, your brand videos, or anything you make as a creative. So first, this is a riser. is a great way to build tension at the start of a video. You will see a lot of creators that do this under their hook. And you can combine it with a hit for more impact, a reverse to accentuate a transition, and then tones or record scratches to accentuate a hook. I have a whole series on Instagram where I use that sensor as part of the hook to get attention. So, Music Bed now has sounds, including all of these, live within their platform. There's over 150,000 plus

curated sounds and you can access them inside the same platform as the music. So you can get all of your audio needs for your videos and creative work inside one place. And there's also now a playlist of some of my favorite tracks. I made a theme for this. It's basically 15 seconds cinema tracks where you can use a little section of it to really quickly invoke a particular type of emotion cuz that's how I like to use audio. You can check all this out and give Music Bed a try at the link in the description. Let's get back to it. Then there's brands. There's like 2Js and Nude Project and folks like this, these kind of more euro focused brands who are basically taking the Stusy playbook and applying it to social media. The 2J's feed is just a like younger Stuy feed with a really good job done of it creating iconography in the same way Stui does doing better use than they do of objects of collabs of this like beach culture making it significantly Euro shooting all this stuff on film have done a great job with it. And it's been a good example of like if you want to be derivative, like let's do something better than the previous brand. Be more appealing than the previous brand. Taking Stusy with plus western iconography, plus more objects, more cars, younger, harder, more vibrant feel. I think they've done great work with. And one of the interesting parts about them is is the adrenaline that comes within the content. This is not an underrated thing to think about where it's like the video of the back of the boat. This is like a light version of this, but one of their biggest ones that popped off, I think was like a big foundational moment for that brand was when someone was actually hopping off of a was doing like a cliff dive in the 2J shirt. Here we got the video here. I guess it was a big moment, probably one of their first blowup videos, 364,000 likes. But again, this is adrenaline focused content. That is a good angle for younger brands or brands that have that kind of mythos to be able to do. And again, we're seeing that dirt bikes is super again, this is this is Stuy content, but they're running it in a better social fashion in a way Stuy probably would never do in kind of the modern era. And that is a like a recipe for saying what was a successful thing. How do we take that styles? How do we up how it performs on the algorithms? How do we up the intensity? How do we make it more thrill riding, more thrillseeking instead of a sunburn of a logo, tattoo of the logo, that kind of thing. Now, I want to talk about a totally different approach cuz that's a new brand playing in an old playbook. Two of the brands I think are the most interesting in this world are Broken Planet and Dursuites. So Broken Planet I'm gonna pull up on TikTok. I want to talk about their strategy here. I think it's one of the best ones. So they basically have a gang of young people. They they move them out. They're new. Like the blonde girls new as of the last few months. They will have like four six or so of these folks and they basically take them on trips along with the founders and the staff and they go places and they make skits and you can scroll through here on TikTok. They are literally just karaokeing trending audio being fashionable and mobbing around with friends doing stupid young people stuff on camera in exotic places whether that's Paris as Morocco. You can kind of scroll back and you can see they'll have different clothes and different looks. They've got them all dirt biking in Morocco. They've got them all picnicking in Paris. And when you kind of think about it and you're like, how much content is coming out? Because there's a lot of content on the individual people's pages, on the brand owners pages, on the core brand page, it goes in these waves. They're always going somewhere and doing something. Characters kind of move in and out. It's pretty easy content to do all things considered. But the where the cost is, they're employing these creators. They're saying, "Hey, cool. We're going to let you travel to exotic places and we're going to pay you x a month and you're going to make x amount of skits with us." And then they're booking the travel and booking the trips and they're supplying the clothes. You know, versus like traditional setup shoots where you're renting locations and getting more high budget videographers and

photographers versus this is all iPhone. This is probably the same budget, but they get way more content. It's way more Tik Tok relevant. And it's it's interesting and different in a way that I feel like has carved out a really specific niche. And I would say that like for a lot of brands, if you have access to young, good-looking people who will do this and you can build that like lifestyle and travel thing in there, I think this playbook is like extremely it's like underdone at this point. There are brands that are doing I know YG is doing some of these things. Like there's other brands that are doing it, but I think there's a lot of interesting angles and places. I'd love to see the brands that are doing that in like different continents, different areas where I think that is just just the beginning of that strategy and they are early and no matter what, look, they're selling clothes to kids, right? The clothes are for children and so it's a different market. We have to understand what your market looks like. Duruits is another one playing in this new world. They're doing skit-based content. You've probably seen it. So, they have the founder, they have a couple recurring creators. She's in in most of the videos. And they are making skits about fashion boys and fashion girls. the dynamic between the two, the dynamic of being like a person in the modern world who loves clothes, skits that are funny about the clothes around it and has the entirety of their content. And that the genius of this of the strategy is there the clothes get to be in every video, but you get to be entertaining enough to be shared, but they also have accounts by regions. There's a duruit's London account has different creators on there making London specific content in London. This is like the kind of the genius of it is you get a good idea, you can then move it across your locations and that helps feed the London store because algorithms are localized. If you are in London, it will show you content of other people traveling in London of what to do in London. If you live there, it will show you stuff around it. The algorithm is good at that. They're doing this for New York with the New York store now and kind of you can watch them kind of get it off the ground. And this is another one where I think the power of, okay, are we going to do these big budget shoots or are we going to do we're going to employ a lot of creators and be pumping out content. I think this is just as effective now as that traditional ad playbook we're seeing from someone more like 2Js. There's plenty of brands I want to talk about um more high-end true fashion stuff who kind of cross the line like like Martine Rose where it's just pure incredible art direction what that looks like on a luxury level. Only so much time in this video. I'm going to move into the playbook section here. So the playbook for success and what you're seeing every brand do. The first is spectacles with production. Like this is what you're competing against. Nike is, you know, has giant chunks coming out of a building with cars with golf balls on top of them. People are spending money on pop-ups and productions. There's a spectacle element. A lot of the 2J stuff, they had their giant stars logos on, big metal cutouts in in the desert. People are are creating these kind of moments you can make content around and get people involved with or people to go photograph. So, I think it's important to call out because basically every brand is doing their version of that. There's an IRL experience version of it. I would keep it on your radar as you scale. But the crucial core things is ecom style. How are you shooting your ecom photos? Like that is an opportunity. How your videos show up on your actual product pages? What are you doing for social creators? Who are you employing to be able to have that like actually on your feed making content every day? How are you doing lookbooks and distributing them? Like someone like Kasa Eris is a lookbook with every one of those launches and then corresponding ecom photos that go with it. And then what is your distribution? You have organic platforms and then how are you promoting that on ads and then how are you seeding or doing other things and to elevate those you need concepts for social like we saw with cold culture. Whether that's you're actually doing the the lip-s syncing stuff that broken

planet is or skits like Dur Shoots is or elevating like adrenaline content the way 2J's is. Every one of those brands has concepts behind their shoots. If you're not doing concepts with this, I don't think you're breaking through into good art direction. And then environment. Where are you filming this? How are you creating this? What teams do you have? Broken Planet's moving that environment around. ALD had that kind of recurring environment of where they actually shot to begin to tell the brand story. And how are you bringing these experiences into real life? Because this is so competitive. Having a popup and documenting it the way like House of Errors is taking over LA. We just saw that Nike stuff. Like how are you then making content that applies in that region and then making interesting art direction actually comes with. This is a great video set for House of Errors to promote like a pop-up that's happening in in LA. How are you bringing all that together? Like these things add up to the foundation of creative in street wear because like I mentioned in the beginning, not only do the clothes have to be amazing now or at least amazing for their target demo, the actual creative has to be on that next level. And then you actually really need to sell and fulfill and be like doing things that are interesting because that's the standard for success. It is a hard niche to participate in. A bit of a different ending to this video. This week I'm launching a new business. As many of you know, I've been doing creative strategy and creative direction freelance for brands now while I create content for a while. In the newest business, I'm actually training teams inside of agencies and inside of brands to get better at organic social strategy and paid social strategy. I am rolling this out at the end of September. And in the meantime, I'm actually looking for people, seven in particular. I have three set up already to help me run a beta of this to actually test out everything I have inside the curriculum before I roll it out to the agency partners. So if you are super junior or you have your own brand, this is not for you. But if you are working in marketing, any kind of creative space and you want to learn how to be a creative strategist to make organic strategy for brands or to run ads or to get better at it and learn my playbook. Basically what I am offering is you will get a super discounted rate and we will connect onetoone on that so I can also learn and get feedback on if you think this is good and valuable. As always, if you don't like it, I will just refund it and then in turn I can make sure I am honed in before I get into this launch. So, if that is you and that is something that's interested to you, I want to get seven more people in this beta. I have a type form down below that you can fill out and I will shoot over all the info and then y'all will see when that business launches and I will talk more about it here when I do launch it at the end of September. But in the meantime, I figured this would be the perfect audience who might actually be looking for this that I can get some help evaluating this with. As always, thank you so much for watching this video. I've got a fun lineup over the next few weeks. I'm going to link some of my other popular art direction videos here. Look forward to seeing you next week.

Why everything is a luxury now

So, in the past few years, we've had what I call little treat culture. This is where people have chosen to spend their money on fancy snacks, fancy beverages, little purchases, $5, $20 to basically get that little dopamine hit, make them feel better about their lives. This is a cultural trend. But right now, we're seeing a shift into what I like to call little luxuries. You've seen this term likely online. But this is the idea that you can purchase an everyday item that is elevated. You basically overpay for it, pay a premium, but it is something that is special and appeals to you. You really care about that particular part of your day. This could range anything from like a little shower head that gives you an amazing experience with your water

to like a sleep cover to something fun for your home. Basically, this idea that a better user experience and a more premium aesthetic justifies a more premium price point and why people choose to buy like that. So, in this video, I'm going to talk about how we got here. How did this become such a dominant trend and how to think about this as a person if you're actually trying to decide if you want to buy one and then show you the playbook if you're developing a brand, how you participate in this little luxury culture. Now, I'm going to break down a dozen brands in the category from tool kits to laundry detergent sheets to vegetables. I actually can't wait cuz these are some of the funnest best brands to talk about that you are going to learn from and then you might actually want to buy. And you can sign up for a recap of this where I'll actually list out all those brands and this playbook in next week's hyper that is in the description. If you ever want something like my videos all written out, I'm going to start providing that in the newsletter each week. But we're going to kick off with how we got here. Why did we get to this little luxury culture? Let's lock in. So, first let's talk about the cheapification. I don't even know if that's a word of everything. And this comes down to Amazon and availability of the global economy. Not to get macroeconomic here, but there was a massive sea change in our entire world when Alibaba was invented. We all know the term Alibaba, but we aren't super ingrained into what happened. Really, what happened there is a platform was created that opened up factories across the world to the United States and to entrepreneurs in the United States. Prior to that, you have to actually go to China and hunt down a factory, which is significantly harder than going online and browsing materials and communicating through chat. And the cost savings of this was so massive. You saw all these new entrepreneurial businesses pop up. And at the same time, we had Amazon where anything could get delivered to your door. And so we saw people saying, "Hey, I can launch a brand and just by availability on Amazon, I can be a choice." Amazon took off. Everyone wanted to start a business on there. And this applied to people that were arbitrageing goods from China and applied to Chinese brands too where people said, "We can by virtue of cost put something online." And so much of the population buys so many of their things from Amazon and so much is a function of price. It led to the overall quality and then the cost of brands just continuing to decrease and decrease. It was all about who could offer something 10 cents cheaper. How can you bundle more packs inside of it, it became a genuine race to the bottom. And then with the shipping scenario, the last few kind of pre-tariff worlds and Timu and Shien, all of a sudden they said, "Hey, we can actually ship goods direct from China to your door. we can offer even greater savings on so many things versus importing cartons and warehousing. And this has led to basically everything we consume online a huge chance that there is kind of like a trash really cheap item because of the culture associated with this and these big macroeconomic shifts. I'm going to take my macroeconomic hat off real quick and then we're going to dive into the entrepreneur hat. So what does that mean for you? It used to mean if you want to enter a category as a new brand, one of the best positions you could take was to go cheaper. Basically say, "Hey, this hammer is 20 bucks. I'm going to get it from China. I'm a smaller business. I can actually sell that at 18 bucks and I can get that customer who wants it to be cheaper. Now that cheap trying to sell something at a lower cost that is done. You cannot win in basically any category on price. It is a horrible method with which to compete. Instead, what we're seeing is the idea that hey, well, the hardest thing to replicate is actual user experience, aesthetics, content, all the things that I talk about on this channel. So, the idea is to make it as good as you can. Take an item and make it amazing and then charge a premium for it. And now there's an erosion of the middle ground. on the middle ground all went to the bottom and then all the people that provide a premier user experience at the top. And so the brands that really win

kind of live in that middle to high-end where they get that premium experience but don't charge an overweight for it because they've been able to achieve some scale. This is a sweet spot for success in the west right now with a brand versus just with a product sold on price. And all of these brands I'm going to show here today are examples of that. So what is the recipe? There's a recipe for these products that will help make them successful. The first is experience. basically offering a proumer level product and education about why it's so good. So let's look at the coffee machine market for instance. So you now see these super automatic machines like the Terra Cafe, you see Jura, you see Fellow, a bunch of these companies that came about saying we have better looking machines. They're easier to use. They p perform at a proumer level and they aren't presented or marketed like the previous generation of brands and they differentiate purely through that kind of better super automatic experience. The second level is performance. basically quality and durability. It's doing better than what you did prior. It filters your water better. You have a candle that burns longer. Whatever it is is saying we are going to have better performance than in the existing tier of the market. And these two things go together. And with a third thing that is mandatory and all this, that is aesthetic. It's basically performative, but this idea of the aesthetics of everything. How can you make everything in your home or everything you choose to interact with more beautiful? One of the items I'm going to walk through here today is called the Tinker Toolkit. Is literally a tool kit that has been like millennialified. It does have some experience pluses and the grips and the way it's put together, but literally it's just a more beautiful looking nature of an existing thing in your home. And there are hundreds of examples of products like that. And the three of these together, experience, performance, and aesthetic, are the holy grail of being able to market an item that you can charge a premium for. And one of the reasons for that is if you have those three things, they is built for standout content. You're able to constantly explain in ads why it's better because of the experience you provide, because of the performance it delivers. You have actual stats you can rattle off and say this is why this is worth more money. And then you have the nature of hey, this is a beautiful looking thing. So it immediately hooks better and looks better in content, which is an innate advantage. Take a little break for a personal anecdote about how I learned this. So I used to uh be a partner in an agency called Gwyn Partners when I lived in Texas. We were a product development agency and we did some go to market as well. I was working on this with an entrepreneur friend of mine named Colin Gwyn who is a person who has been the most obsessed with user experience in hardware product and product overall of anyone I've ever met. He is lives in the religion of product experience development. It's what he thinks about how he thinks the way I can ideulate and think about content and give you an idea or a strategy in seconds. He thinks that way about product. And one of the things that we worked on there in addition to applying that methodology to a lot of products and he'd worked on things like the DJI Phantom when it initially came out as one of his projects. So was a DJI Inspire. He's also the person that came up with the idea for Gel Blaster and how it was packaged in the United States. Many people know I worked there too. It actually spun out of that agency. But we developed Gel Blaster because he saw that vision in the internal hours of the company. So we would dedicate a certain percentage of hours at our agency to our internal projects. There's a couple interesting ones of those. The current really interesting one is actually a diagnostic software for any piece of hardware with a smart battery. That's probably for a different video. But the gelb blaster one was 100% based on if you have kids and you have Nerf, you know, it doesn't really live up to the potential of it experience. And then when you actually look at the competitors, they all look like real weapons, which is not something that you want to sell. So this idea that you could have a better experience and

have it look cool like a video game and potentially video gamify it was the entire road map for a better aesthetic, better performance, and a better experience than you were having with this existing world of Nerf. And that's how Gel Blaster, which is a tens of millions of dollars a year business, was built out of. It's a Walmart, Costco, etc. And watching that come from this guy's head into reality and the relentless focus on experience, performance, and aesthetic throughout that company is a big part of why those fundamentals like live with me in every project today. So next, let's actually dive into some of these brands. I'm going to break down what makes them special and what you can learn from them. All right, so first I want to talk about vacation. Many of you have heard of this brand or know this brand, ultra popular, but they basically took the aesthetic part of this playbook and a bit of the experience part and made a incredible brand out of it. This is an aestheticsdriven brand that people will pay a slight premium for over existing products to basically change a category to change the entire sunscreen category. In some cases, it offers a slightly better experience, but 90% of this is aesthetics driven. And you look at any traditional category like that where on the shelf, everything looks kind of boring. Really, the other best company in this category is SunBum, which is a company I consume a lot of. It's really popular out here in Orange County where they are also kind of like a more modern, fun version of your average sunscreen. Everything else on shelf is painfully dullled. Then you have these two brands, you can kind of choose your route between a sunbum and a vacation. And you see when you see it on shelf or you go into these displays inside any retail store that is a purely you're magnetically driven to the aesthetic of this and this aesthetic then enables better content. I have a viral video with this whipped cream sunscreen. This is a form factor play where they're now adding the aesthetic and a bit of the experience where when you come out it looks like whipped cream. I did the video talking about this packaging and putting it on my hand. It blew up cuz people are basically getting into that dissonance of chaos packaging and it has a viral factor and you want to buy it for that and it's fun when you do bring it out. And same thing now with the scents and the approaches they've had to more traditional '8s things. They're adding a product element to it. But this is one of the best basic ideas think people can learn from this if you have aesthetic mastery in your toolkit. A lot of brands I talked to want to be like a vacation but they don't understand aesthetics on this level and don't have the ability to retain design talent. A brand like this comes about because the people inside of it from the highest level to the lowest level live and breathe lifestyle and aesthetic. Now, if you are like that, if you are in a design firm, you have a design-driven group of friends or entrepreneurs, you can probably execute something conceptual like this. But if everyone is not obsessive at this level, there's no way to contrive something that goes as deep into it as this does. I want to follow this up with Jolie. Jolie is a product I have a complicated relationship with because I am a very anti subscription products. And so, for reference, this is a shower head. It is a $152 shower head and they're selling you a subscription for the filters in it to give you filtered water. And they're basically saying the water coming out of your shower is really dirty. You should do something about that. Also, you're going to get the benefit. It's going to improve your skin and hair by doing something about it. So, there's a consumer benefit. And they market that relentlessly, really, really well. Again, shower head, something we all have. You may have thought of replacing it for a basically a different type of water flow or maybe you want a certain look, but that's probably the most anyone's ever spent thinking about it. and they said, "Hey, let's monetize this category better by offering a better experience. Also looks pretty good. There's this color element to it." And they're kind of getting into this performance. Cut down hair shedding, frizziness, dry skin, and acne. Uh that's a pretty good value proposition when you really start looking at the stats. Uh if they can back that up, but

it's a subscription product. And there's so many of these products now. Uh eight sleep is another one where I even though I know you're getting value out of I know it's a good experience, they're trying to charge you every month to have a shower or whatever that looks like is I have like an intrinsic problem with. I know this one is filter based, so maybe you can do that every year or whatever, but the subscription model does get to me a little bit, but this is an amazing example. They identified a category, said, "How can we improve it?" And they're monetizing at the best level because they have a recurring sale as part of that with these filters. And I do think there is a world of hardware from sconces to door handles to every little thing that we use in the world that has the potential for someone to say, "We're going to improve the aesthetic. We're going to increase the user experience the way Jolie did." I'm going to bring out the Tinker box I mentioned before, but basically this is a hardware tool kit. It has the grips like the OXO good grips that are really easy to use. Actually got this because my son, I wanted him to have a tool kit that he could feel good about using. They've really thought through the how all this works from the different heads of the screwdriver and how they come in and out. Here there's a really well put together tool kit, but looks nothing like the DeWalt or the tool kits you have. Like if I was to show you the tool kits in the rest of my shed, it's literally like most dudes like just a I have a DeWalt box and like a box of hammers, you know, like that's not exactly the uh the the millennial aesthetic dream and they've kind of built something that fits this aesthetic with a few different colors. But I want to talk about this because I think this is a really important one to think about is there is a huge generation we don't think about a lot, especially if you did have a background like this. Like I don't know, I had a very uh I had a very hands-on father who built things. He had construction as one of the summer jobs he I like watched him build a house, how to like a workshop and a woodshed. I learned a lot about everything from changing a car oil to being able to use a multitude of tools from that experience. But there's a huge generation of people and especially now some Gen Z and Gen Alpha people who just did not have that upbringing or care whatsoever. And there's a whole cottage industry of content around that that's popping up. and guy, a creator who's on my same management agency. This guy Drew Hungrenson. He's one of several who've blown up by basically making content that teaches Gen Z basic life skills like, "Hey, how to clean your bathroom, how to clean dishes, how to steam your clothes, how to take care of your girlfriend, how to get rid of pit stains." This is his content and it rips. And I think and this is really big because it's this niche you have of like, "Hey, did you not have parents who educated you on this?" Cuz a good percent of the population didn't. it is what it is. They're filling that gap with like, "Hey, I'm a friendly person. Who's going to teach you these essentials of life? This is this is how a gas grill works, right? This is a cottage industry of content." And cuz there's a lot of people that just don't know. And then there's now a industry of the things for those people to buy when they do choose to do it because it may be intimidating for them to go in and purchase a DeWalt tool set. And they may want something that is a little more along the lines of their minimalist or aesthetic home. And that's where you get a brand like Tinker comes in. And when you combine the two into the education, like for instance, their videos they're coming out with are like building my at home gym, painting hacks, assembling furniture, and you know, a new shower head and how you and using the toolkit. They are leaning into educationbased content around this in a way that you're going to see very little of from the traditional brands. And that is where the alpha is the combination of aesthetics. As you can see here, they're kind of playing into this baby blue, these different colors, the blue tool set that I have. And they're basically helping enable a generation to DIY with the product and the content. And it's smart positioning. And so if you see something, it was one of the first things I thought of when I

saw Drew's content. And so I was like, "Oh man, the TAM, the total available market of people that learned nothing from their mothers and fathers is probably massive." And then if you want to sell into that with tools enabled by content, there is something absolutely massive there. And either existing brands will capitalize it or new ones will. And another brand I want to talk about is DeadCool. Dead Cool is a really, really interesting brand to me. Oddball name, but Dead Cool is a scent in a fragrance company. That's one of the most fascinating categories. I don't think there's enough interest for me to do an entire video on fragrance. I would love to, but they're one of the most interesting because this is a hyper competitive category, right? Gen Z is extremely into fragrance. People are more into fragrance than ever. Companies are marketing them hard. They sell a ton of them on Tik Tok shop. There's cottage Tik Tok related to fragrance. People are more into it than ever. But if you're just selling a candle, if you're a new candle brand or a new fragrance brand, you're in for a world of hurt. That is a hard hard market to work in. It's ultra competitive. Then also people need to experience your product. And how are you going to let them do that? But what DeadCool's done that's really interesting is like I don't even particularly like the branding, but they've got a killer scent. They have uh this extra milk scent. This was a sleeper forever now. It's one of like the most popular scents in the world. Is a truly incredible scent. And then what they do is they don't actually just put out a single item for it. Every time when you go to a fragrance, you can shop by extra milk. And what here they've done is they've productized it. So I can get lotion, I can get laundry detergent, hand cream, linen spray. I don't even know what that is. that say I'm I'm I'm too straight for linen spray, dryer sheets, body wash, hand wash, refills, and then the actual traditional fragrance, plus these scrubs, mini sizes. They basically said if we get a good scent, we're going to productize that across 20 things cuz you know what? I have too many fragrances. I've got so many fragrances, especially from like the influencer flow that comes in. Like I'm never going to purchase one again likely. But you know what? If I really like this scent, what will I will get? Like, okay, it's a consumable. Laundry Sheets is a consumable. So, if I every next time I'm out and I'm thinking about it or the brand pops on my feed, that's a way for me to experience it. I think that's a really smart thing for a fragrance brand or a brand in general to think about if you have a killer category is how do you spread it wide into the different ways people actually consume. And so, I want to check in on them. They are also on particle and let's see exactly kind of how that's doing and what that does inside this category and kind of a little bit of uh maybe even how they how they market. All right. So, I want to look at here. Let's look at yeah the assets here. This is the interesting part of this one is so Particle will actually go in and tell you the different things that happen. So like you can look at their SMS marketing. So I can actually literally pull up all the SMSs that they've sent. I can look at the IG posts and I can look at their homepage changes. They take screenshots of that every X days whenever they change the pop-up and kind of piece together the story of what they're doing to promote these products. And same thing going back to Vacation. One thing I think every brand should do who's trying to be interesting is go in here and look at Vacation's email in particular and their homepage changes like changes to their popup. You can see them like promoting their Awan smoothie like via email. The aesthetics of what they're doing. They are the best company in my opinion to pull from if you have a nice visual world for examples of what your brand can do. So anyway, all that is within particle. One of the other things that's interesting within particle too is you're trying to be like, hey, if I want to start a brand or I want to work on a brand, what do I do within there? They have this trend section which I love to browse which is just rise in search volume. I always like to set this to two years. You can see seasonality like what people buy during the summer, people buy during the winter. like you

see these big dips, but are people looking for you like dog shirts is like obviously trending up? There could be a lot of reasons for any of these. Remember, I'm just kind of like looking browsing for ideas or like in category. It's worth kind of going in here. You can go into some like different categories, break some different things down, and you can begin to see, okay, like ceilings, decorations. This is like a category that's on the rise. That's one where I would I think is an interesting one to invest in. Septum rings, you know, let's go having a comeback. Like what can you do for a brand there? Just another one of these tools that makes an investment in a market research tool like this useful beyond just that initial data grab. So anyway, you can learn more about Particle at the link down below and I appreciate them for sponsoring this video. And then that ties into this sleepwware moment. Business of fashion had this came out talking about brands like Lake Everj, Sleepy Jones, Petite Plume that basically uh how big sleepwear is getting inside its category. And this is a great example of that little luxury concept where your sleep time, how you want to be the most comfortable or feel the best about yourself. if you sell luxury sleepwware. So, as many of you know, I work with a brand called understated leather. We sell a lot of sleepwware. It's we've been on this trend for since ahead of the curve really. It's been about probably a year and a half, two years we've been on sleepwware. Jen, the designer there, always like works way ahead of the curve in terms of what she understands, but people really want to have like a cute sleep set. We actually had organic posts from celebrities like reading books or lounging about in our sleepwear because it's comfortable and it's a luxury. You're like, "Hey, you know what? I sleep every night. I deserve a $150 set of PJs or whatever it And it's just a great example of that in a non- tech category or a non-h hardware category. But in fashion, what is that experience that we are going to turn into a luxury? That already happened. You athleisure did that with an entire category. People now spend way more money on active wear and their shorts and their tank tops than ever. But every little piece of the human experience is going to get that moment and brands are going to be created for it. And that's not to say that everyone needs that. They certainly don't. But it's all about the choosing those one or two things that mean a lot to you and choosing where you have those little luxuries. Another one to bring up around the home is this brand, Goodland. They do hot and cold tubs, but they also do this everlasting garden hose. And this was one that was a painoint for me cuz I got a hose. Uh I we still wash our own cars. I like to wash my car with my son. Uh I think it's a fun bonding experience. Feels good to complete something with your own hands every once in a while. And I found that like we just couldn't get a hose with good pressure and good options. I ordered like multiple hoses on Amazon, went to Home Depot. Everything was kind of cheap Chinese crap. And so I went to when I saw this product, I'm like, "Okay, it's $125, four times the expense of any Oz I bought or at least double, but lifetime warranty, made in Canada, small batches, guaranteed to rip. It's going to clean the car, right?" Uh, and you looks good, will look good on the side of the house versus the ones I have probably don't. Again, that is an example of a product that like I am all in on the experience and on the aesthetic of what this enables. And it's really interesting. I think about every single one of these items like is a category in itself. So, a few others to call out who I think do a really good job, interesting job with marketing. I'll lean on that angle for a second. One is Techla. So, Techla is a fabrics company. They are kind of a legendary home textile group. They have one of the best brands in the space. Everything is super high quality. You can feel the way it comes through in their photo and video. But they sell very abstractly. They remind me if Stuy was, you know, appealing purely to a uh again their marketing to me is very like is very Stucy just withdrawn into this like backend world into this world of like more suburban, more casual. It doesn't have to feel cool. It just has to feel like real life. So, they've done a good job there and they

are literally selling with shadows and imagery and some of the toolkit of kind of creating a really artful look at a home textile. And it's not like any of the content is crazy viral or anything, but it is thought through enough that it is appreciated. And the people that appreciate things like this are probably the people that spend $240 on, you know, a set of sheets or a $90 House of Voltater times Techla beach towel. So now I want to talk about Flamingo Estate and I also want to talk about Dead Cool. They're two really interesting brands to me. I'm going to use Particle for some of this too. Particle is the sponsor of this video, but they show data behind the scenes on what these companies do. So we're actually going to look at some of that as well. So, Flamingo Estate, I want to start with if you're familiar with this company or not, they are a company that started as a vegetable delivery service in LA has expanded to really beautiful homegoods. But even that initial start, it's basically saying, "Hey, do you want to get your vegetables yourself or do you want a box of vegetables delivered to you boutique by people in LA is 100% a little luxury. And now you see everything from creams to every bath substance you like under the sun to honey. They have honey from specific celebrity uh maybe from celebrity bees or bees that go in celebrity gardens. Every single item inside this website is a little luxury, like a crazy jam. I've brought I've bought these spicy guillo strawberries. I know I butchered the pronunciation there. I know they're like $82. They're amazing. If you're doing like an ordev uh platter, they're incredible. But every single thing that they sell falls in this category where you're paying a premium for something really special, presented really special that they have taken the time to source and put together. And so when I talk about this category a lot, people are always like, "Well, how much money could this category possibly make? What could people possibly do? What could possibly sell for people like this?" And so that's why I love to use Particle. I'm going to drop into the software here. We're actually going to look at Flamingo Estate. And we're going to look at the last four weeks. Particle and this data will be like directionally correct. Doesn't have to be perfect. 4.8 million this month online just on the website and they're in stores and they do like all these pop-ups and stuff. Let's look at what's actually selling. I can actually dive into this. Okay, what is the top selling product by volume? It's actually these gift sets. They are selling a hell of these gift sets. Those are bundled products doing hundreds of thousands of dollars. They're selling 90 plus of a day. And that's a really interesting thought. If you're not bundling, if you have a product with multiple sets, I obviously bundle on valuable now. You can get multiple bags, you can get multiple shirts, but if you have sell multiple products online, you're not creating bundles like this with like a specialized package, like just take a look at this flamingo estate. Like they are all of their top products are duos or tours, which are like multi-bundles. Every one, all the top five products by volume. This isn't even top five products by by dollar. And then you go down into candles, 2,000 plus candles a month for each of these flavors. And you keep scrolling down, they're putting up serious sales across every single one of these categories. And it just goes to show you that I think the market for these little things where, you know, I think people have prolonged now these big purchases. They say, you know what, I'm never going to own a house. I'm not filling my retirement account. I'm not here to argue for the good or ills for society of these things. But but basically, the solution for a lot of people is, you know what, the happy thing for me is I'm going to keep this apartment, but I'm going to be able to buy the candle that I love or the wash set or whatever it is. And there is now a huge economy around enabling that. So, I want to uh end with an example of uh starting some of this from scratch. So, this is a brand that was in Cut 30 the other month called Hashi Home, and they sell premium ceramics and premium things for the house. It's a great brand. I believe is just the one woman who's doing everything from the design. She's packing orders and she's making

stuff on Instagram. But I want to talk about content strategy for something like this. And uh what she ended up working on through Cut 30 and has really popped off. She's now gotten to about 9,000 followers. she was starting from from very low is she basically made a set in her home that she can entertain and make content on. It's all about this kitchen table and this dinner table and basically saying, "Hey, I'm going to use this place in our house. I'm going to film content there." Again, this is just her kitchen. I'm going to host on it and I'm going to be able to make content. And she's kind of making skits and ideas around that that attract people that are interested in hosting. That is the top offunnel content. And there's more educational content in there, like how do you create a sexy dinner party to behind the scenes of her actually making and documenting the brand, talking about different types of decor, and then funneling all this into actually selling the product, packing an order with her, getting a real glimpse at the things you buy. I think this is the formula. If you are selling within this, you have one of these aesthetic, a seriousdriven objects, get a set, a place in your house or a place in the office where you can tell the story dynamically and then use that combination of humor, information, and documentation to tell that via short form video. And it is a recipe for success. And to end with this and talk through the category, one of the things that uh I think is most impactful, one of the biggest trends we're going to see is that people are spending so much money on fashion, it's overwhelming. Now, I think there's going to be a trend where people are going to be almost stopping that, looking back at what they have in their closet and reinvigorating that. I think designers are seeing this, too. And you see this with JW Anderson and Jonathan Anderson, who basically said, "Hey, we're switching our whole brand." He moves into Dior, moves to luxury. We're switching our brand to objects to things that are personally crafting spaces. He's selling spoons, all kinds of like accutramonts that are uh accessories that match the existing kind of clothing for the brand, but they are moving into objects and things for the home. And that idea of these spaces and these things being like the next kind of aesthetic frontier that people are going to be buying into, I think is very real. If you want to be in the home space and selling things into that, I think that is the space to be activating on in these next like 18 months versus in CPG or in apparel. Just my two cents. But anyway, that was this video on little luxuries. Like I mentioned, I will summarize this with every brand that I talk through and a link to that kind of playbook I overview. All that's going to be in this week's hyper newsletter that is in the bio as well as info on particle for sponsored this video. If you have any questions about this or you have brands or interesting little luxuries you feel other people would want to check out, please drop them in the comments. I want to see them and I'm sure other people would be interested as well. For me to dive deeper on anything around this. I'm kind of planning out these next videos. Feel free to let me know. I hope you found some value as both a consumer and someone working on brands or on creative things in this video. Thank you so much. \[Music\]

Manual creativo para marcas de moda (caso práctico de Loewe)

In this video, we are going to go through the art direction of LE, one of the funnest, most interesting brands of probably this last decade. They are the epitome of Spanish luxury. They not only make true luxury heritage items, but they also cross over and crush it on new channels like Tik Tok. And this is the perfect time to do this video because their creative director, Jonathan Anderson, has just left for Dior. So, I want to take some time and appreciate that era. I had a blast pulling all this together and really taking an indepth look at the art direction the brand has done in their campaigns, in their presentation, and on their

social media. So, we're going to break it down for you as a toolkit of what this means for brands, what this means for you as a creative, and what you can learn from them about your own creative work. We're going to talk through recurring ideas and the motifs they use in a lot of their campaigns. We're going to talk through the foundations of art direction for a luxury house like this and what do they actually build their world around? editorial, still life, behind the scenes, sets, even events and showcases. And we're going to talk about concepts and the visual concepts that really help define their brand and make all these mismatch of things feel distinctly low. And then I'm actually going to walk through their social media, their Tik Tok in particular, and just break down some of the content and tactics that have been so effective for them to stand out in the new world. I am super excited for this one. This is by far the funnest of the art direction videos that I've done after Stuy and Rick and all these others. excited for y'all to come on the ride. Let's lock in. So, first I want to take a look at what Lee looked like a decade ago. So, if we look at their 2013 ad campaign, it has Penelopey Cruz in it. They're showcasing the Amazon bag. But literally, the call out for this campaign is that they used a wide angle lens for it. That's how far the creative and campaigns have come from this era and this look and feel to the fun and playfulness of the full realization of the Jonathan Anderson era. And one thing I love and appreciate about brands like this is they've actually published so much of their work over time. So in 2017, they published two books just on their past, present, and future showcasing their campaigns, their creative process, what they're thinking, presenting their images and what they do as art. And this documentation is something I feel is important and everyone should think about as their brand and their creative. If you are making amazing, interesting art, then actually showing that and displaying it as such and releasing it as such, documenting it is a big part of that process. I ordered something from House of Errors the other week and I got like a book about House of Errors in the box. Like they're actually making sure that people know the work that they're putting into their creative and they're publishing it in that way. Let's start off by talking about the recurring motifs. So every brand visually when you're making campaigns, it's good to have a visual toolkit that you can refer back to kind of time and time again that has recurring things that come up inside the imagery. So for Lee, this is placement within nature. You will see that so little of their campaigns happen in anything modern. It happens a lot outside. You see greenery, you see the landscape, you see part people participating in something in the world, rarely indoors. And this might seem subtle, but it's important part of the brand. It would be completely different than if you always saw someone in an environment or if they're always in a brutalist postmodern environment, always near buildings, always with technology. That choice to embrace nature is a visual choice that when it's a throughine over enough time really begins to define a brand. And the second one, and perhaps what they are most known for to casual observers in today's era, is the use of fruit and vegetables within their campaigns. Mostly fruit. I will argue over whether tomato is a fruit in a separate video. Does have seeds, but they are leaning into this in the form of their products and in the direction of everything around them from the packaging. This iconic LeeBe tomato that you'll now see is on their bags, is in their website, is on their social media. They're turning big balloons and turkey into this. They are taking this idea of this real world natural item of fruit and applying it across the expanse of what they do. And I feel like identifying those objects that can stand for your brand is really interesting and important. And so they've taken motifs like this and they've applied it to still life. We'll talk about this in the foundation section of this video in a second, but they do lots of campaigns that basically just feature their products intermixed with fruit. But then they've also taken that into editorial. So in this campaign I'm showing right here, one of their more kind of prolific

ones, there's no product shown inside these. It is purely the models of this campaign. This LE kind of look with fruit in their mouths. And that is representative of the campaign and collection that they were doing for the time without any product shown. And with that, with this still life comes this idea of product as sculpture that when they're presenting it, you're presenting as if you present an art object as if it is something that is about to be painted. This is an art direction choice that they're choosing in terms of how they show their product when they do show it. You will rarely see anything that comes from the brand that is presented in any kind of normal light angle or circumstance. It is always presented as if it is a solo art object or is it if it is a still life in context of art being documented or created. And so of those three, the nature, the fruit, the product is sculpture. The first three pillars. The next two are a bit of a departure. Next one is craft. And something this is every luxury brand should have. But this dedication to what makes this product unique? Why does it take so much time? Why is it so expensive? It's something that they relentlessly put inside of their marketing and inside of their campaigns. There's a lot of times a showcase of where something is made, the texture of it, and then also all these unique processes to actually create some of these more complicated things is a throughine that they've leaned into, I think, as much as any luxury brand and especially on their YouTube, which we'll get to in a minute, have really put together an expansive behind the scenes on. And then the last pillar is their location. this highlight of Spain in particular. They've leaned into being a Spanish luxury house by constantly having Spain as a focal point of what they are doing, whether it's recording content there, events there, this yearly release that they have that's all around a visa. They've taken this combination and built that into something uniquely them. So, what can we learn from this as creatives or people with our own brands is to have these through lines. I would say make the decision of where you're shooting. Can you build a through line for that the way that they do with nature? The way they say almost everything they're doing is outside or has greenery in it. What is your decision choice? Are you always inside, always outside, always showing people in a livedin environment, multiple people? What are those decisions you can make to stand out? And same thing with your recurring motifs, the way that they have fruit inside of so many of their shoots. Can you always have cars? That was a through line with a lot of the Stusy work I covered before, tools, animals, like what are those recurring things that you can have as a throughine that over time people begin to automatically associate your brand with wiredhaired dachshund or whatever the way that Lee is associated with the tomato. Then that conversation of how do you shoot your product? They're always presenting their product as sculpture as still life. Do you have a unique way that you can put it there, but you're never showing it on the white background. It's always on concrete or it's always a certain type of lens or you include a macro shot next to the main shot. Is there something you can do to make it stand out? And then if you do have craft to highlight, how do you do it? I think this is a good point in time to talk through some of these craft videos on their YouTube because they basically do a making video in Spain for for the majority of their more popular products. They are showing how they are made. They're walking through the design. They're showing inside the factory. They're having one of the designers inside this place actually walk through the patterns. They're showing this in a level of detail that honestly a lot of these luxury brands rarely show. And they'll do this making of video for those. And you'll see they have episode after episode from the hammock bag to the puzzle wallet. They're laying out every one of the tools that's being used to create it, every piece of leather from the pattern and they're showing that process. And then right next to that, they're leaning into the craft of some actual process. So this entire video is about the ancient craft of kama, which is a Japanese craft of iron tea kettles.

That they are basically just saying, "Hey, we appreciate the craftsmanship of these things so much that we want to document it as part of our marketing and content strategy to associate our brand with people who take their craft incredibly seriously." And then last, this idea of location. So one of my favorite parts about their locations, they have this yearly series, the Paula Aabisa campaign. It's a yearly collaboration collection that they do, but it's always set inside a visa. They're documenting the party and nightlife culture of the island. They're shooting on the location of it, and it becomes a through line. As much as you see them in the actual more developed areas of Spain, they're actually seeing to actually create the products or cut these patterns or do those events. You're getting into this legendary island that's part of that ecosystem to tell a very different story there. But it happens every year like clockwork in collaboration. I think for a lot of brands thinking about where they're from and their culture and what they do there whether that's a yearly surf contest or a rodeo or a race or a meetup or whatever that looks like is there where would you want to appreciate and if you are in Texas do you want to be going down to Trellinga making that a part of your lore or Marfa or some or a massive national park or if you're from you know some kind of very different country and you're doing this all from the Philippines like what are those things you could highlight that are innately related to your culture that you appreciate and want to make part of your brand. So today's video is brought to you by Musicbed. They are an amazing resource for unlimited licensing for music for your creations as a creator or for your brand if you are creating campaigns and content around them. One of my favorite things about Musicbed is the ability they have within their interface to actually search and select. You can search by genre like you see here. They have it broken out by mood attributes if you want to get Latin, Korean, industrial, grungy. You can find specific instruments. You can go advanced and look by key. BPM for speed and you can cut directly into lyrical versus instrumental immediately within any of these categories. So it is a very easy to build a library of things to go through to find the perfect song for you. And to tie this into what we've been talking about here with Lee, like music direction is the way I think most people need to be thinking critically about the content and campaigns they create. So what do I mean by that? When you think about like from a psychology perspective, what is the music you are doing trying to achieve? So a few quick notes there like thinking a lot about speed. Do you want to create space with the music you have so people can take in what the content is saying or do you want to, you know, with something slower or do you want to build up the speed and the pace to make people go along with it? And even things like minor and major keys, like how could that define a brand? We often think about genre to easily define a brand, but take that down lower. Like major keys can be uplifting and like really build some mood, but can get kind of cheesy fast. Minor keys can really evoke emotion. I think thinking about the music direction of projects is really useful. And one other tip I have, one reason I really like browsing music bed like this is I click through songs, I immediately click to the bridge because what I found with like 90% of 15second ads, 30-cond ads, is the part that I want, I'm going to find here in this transition between when they comment down to when and then they bring back in to whatever drop they have is often going to be that emotional moment that's going to work best in your actual campaign. So, you will see me extensively as I browse through this, click into these bridge areas and try to find those moments. Because really, when you're doing music direction like in this era and you're actually looking through these songs, you're looking for a couple things. You're looking for an like an amazing emotional grab that can stop people and make the music a part of what you're doing. Or you're looking for a transition point where you're going to change something in your video from like behind the scenes to what you're actually showcasing or like the transformation where you can basically

do a beat drop and it will basic and there's enough of a hardcore transition. that actually makes like a real emotion come out of it that's evocative. or you're looking for something potentially viral like I have this I hate New York song bookmarked here because for one of the campaigns we're working on I think people would actually potentially use this audio actually make their own version of it because the way he does this thing on the bridge and so if you kind of hunt for that you hunt for those transition points you hunt for those moods you hunt for those viral potential moments like you're beginning to do some real music direction and the last thing is loops one of the keys to especially a lot of vlog content is if you can start it and end it so it feels like it's one continuous thing you're going to get longer view time so I'm also when I'm clicking through these always looking for like is there a banging loop here where I can kind of really nail in that 7 seconds, 15 seconds to match a social campaign. So anyway, these are some of my favorites. I might just do like a music bed playlist of my favorites and publish that like in a future video. Let me know if that's interesting. You can learn more about them and sign up for a free trial of music bed at the link down below. Thank you so much. So those are the pillars, the recurring ideas you see within LEB's content. Now let's talk about the foundations, especially foundations for building like a luxury house like this. How do you what do you build your content around? And from there we'll go into some of the actual art direction concepts you can add into your toolkit. So first every release they do a combination of things and there's a blueprint that most brands follow very similar. They do an editorial release. So basically using models to showcase the items that they are presenting and they also have a still life for this and you will note inside their kind of site where they show off all these collections. They usually put both side by side. So literally as we scroll through this you will see they do editorial with uh Megan Rapeno here but then also they have this still life collection. They're kind of linking both. So they are side by side always identifying that when we do a release we do editorial and then we do still life. And then in addition to that you will see the behind the scenes like I pulled up already of the bags being pulled apart etc. That's a part of every year of that release as part of their toolkit. Editorial still life behind the scenes and then that location element. They're not doing that every campaign but they are doing it every year. They're having this abuses spotlight and this forms the playground within which within which they create content until the Tik Tok era which we'll get to at the end. But one thing I wanted to note about the editorial style of this is they worked with a partner MM MM Paris for many years of the campaigns you see on this list. The last few years looks like they're a little bit less involved but for a lot of the the years leading up to they worked with this one specific partner. I'm scrolling through here specifically on production. They basically got a set made for every single one of these shoots and campaigns that they did by this group in Paris that makes these very intricate, interesting sets. And you'll see within those actual campaigns, they call it out each time they will have this kind of weird black chandelier that every one of the models is set in front of. They will have this incredible rope background pattern. It will have this weird stone heart sculpture that they have here. All this is production that's being engineered specifically to be the anchor of that campaign. That's another big takeaway I think people should think about is everyone's doing these white background shoots now, right? Everyone's shooting inside these studios. They will have a handful of things here or there. Everyone's setting this up. They're obviously putting some props or production, but having someone fabricate a centerpiece for this is a strategy that luxury brands are doing and is something that I think is a great way to find a signature partner, build out a budget, and include within each of these as an approach that you can take because especially in the social media era, that gets more and more interesting because then can you actually put that out in the street for 36 hours

and have your fans interact with it? Can you shoot video in and around it to become a set piece the way I have this behind me that works for the whole season and comes in and out? You display it at trade shows. Bringing those things into the real world, sending it to an influencer's house, whatever it looks like is, you know, kind of a way you can extend that campaign beyond the photo shoot. But I want you to think about from your brand's perspective, what are you doing for editorial? What are you doing for still life? Are you using any set for it? Are you using and if so, what do you do with it to extend beyond that? You doing any behind the scenes? And then are you involving any kind of recurring locations or going back to it within that that will help you take some inspiration from what LOV has put together. But now let's actually go to visual concepts. Probably the most interesting part of the art direction toolkit is less all these kind of foundations and the more tactical stuff I outlay, but like what are the ideas? What's interesting? So they have combination of four things that I've identified and appreciate about that toolkit. You may look at it slightly differently. I will never pretend in any of these videos to be the end all resource on Rick or Lobe or any of this. I am just an appreciator and just trying to break it down in ways I feel people can learn from. So, I know someone deep in the lore may look at this differently. Let's look at surrealism and displacement as the first one. Basically, unexpected object pairings, odd compositions, like dreamlike elements. It's just a constant recurring thing inside of everything we saw. But it's rooted in in realism, right? Even those last few fabrication pieces we looked at where it's like these massive coils of rope. It's all feels familiar. It feels real. It's just somehow displaced, oversized, put out there in a way that we never expected. But it's doing this rooted in reality versus someone like Jacqu Moose who's rooted in a in a inherent playfulness and almost goofiness in how that's put together. Something that feels very much more French versus this feels Spanish. I'd apologize to all my euros, but I'm not afraid of you. Negative space and stillness is the next one. This idea of a calm, almost eerie minimalism that forces the eye to focus. Not like hammering in that they're trying to sell you something, but basically suggesting that you look at this thing that is like featured inside the composition. And third, the art and sculpture references are super obvious throughout. so much of this where they're basically staging these photos like museum installations. And even these campaign sets, even the way you show that behind the scenes looks like something that's about to have a glass pane put over it and then be placed in a museum. And this is just a composition technique, right? How can we take something in the real world? Let's take the way things are presented inside a museum and present our products the same way. And then last, this idea of kind of humor and absurdity. They're not a brand that's afraid to have fun. And but the playfulness is done through essentially like a dead pan weirdness. It's not done through like a haha funny. And one thing I encourage lots of brands to do is a lot of brands are afraid of humor. But humor, especially in the social media era, is so crucial, right? Because it's just a core human emotion that immediately gets you more views, saves, and shares. And so, as opposed to trying to make someone laugh, you or tryh hard fashion in general, they're kind of living in this middle ground where like you inherently appreciate it, that's nuanced, but you don't have to be nuance. can pick your ability to say, "Hey, our brand actually, it's more at our behest to kind of do some dad jokes or to have this really elevated level of humor or to be tasteful about it or for it to be more like slapstick, so it's just more visceral when it goes about it." Think about those approaches and like how that could work within your creative toolkit, whether that's campaign by campaign, brand by brand, or or for you. So, now last, I want to actually walk through their social media cuz they've done an incredible job with it. And we can walk through some of the tactics. This is the world that I live in the most. If you had talked to me a couple years ago, I would be

spending most of my time on campaign shoots. Right now I spend most of my time in tactical social media. What do we do week to week, monthtomonth? And they've got a fun approach for some of this. Something that they do excellently I think a lot of brands can learn from on TikTok is they will take a viral video, something that is happening in the culture, and just remake it. This is a classic brand strategy where they will just get the original influencer and they will just redo it. Reformation was kind of like the queens of this a few years ago where they would literally take creators that make an amazing video type or had a viral video and be like, "Remake this video wearing a Reformation dress." This is the essentially this version of this where we've seen these videos, these people swinging off boats before. She just happens to be doing it in a reformation dress, but they're not afraid of playing into trending sounds. This is a very account that is willing to have fun. Same thing with this. This is just another trend that they are acting on. And it's funny how few brands feel uh they're willing to participate in trends, but then the brand is elevated as Lee is also trying to do it. So, this was a uh this was a trend where you were seeing where people would have like something to take the edge off. They had like a piece of carrot cake where you typically hold a sig. They're doing this here with progressively bigger and bigger candles. And there's just something to playing into those trends and letting some of the absurdism of your product go into it. But as you watch us scrolling through this, they're doing all types of content. There's no limitation to what the content looks like. You don't know what to expect. And that is a strategy in itself. But they're doing a lot of it by engaging influencers, having them on their own accounts. Like she's opening a blind box. They're hosting stuff with influencers inside of their actual events. You do not know what you're going to see. This is all right next to like a process video of something being made. You do not know what you're going to expect in the Lee account. I think that is a good thing for the majority of luxury brands to be willing to put any all these kind of concepts out there. This is them inflating their giant tomato balloon and showing the behind the scenes. And again, this isn't a Tik Tok format. That is the default Tik Tok font. This was shot on an iPhone. This is not a high production quote unquote luxury video. It is conceptual and it shifts into it with some of the footage they have at the end. Another one with a collaboration with where they are literally doing a trend. I say a lot of this to say that a lot of brands take Tik Tok way too seriously. You need to be unexpected. If you are doing something normal, you're doing something repetitive on there. If it does not work, if it's not putting out crushing views, you need to just focus on being more interesting and more exciting within that. And they've built this world where it does not matter at all. One of the things I really want to call out around this is the way that they've leveraged influencers. What they've done for that is they've done like let influencers be good at what they are going to do and what they do already. So, one of these I want to call out is uh Adnan who makes content very similar to what I uh make on TikTok or used to make. I make less of it now where he's kind of doing histories of fashion or luxury or telling some of the stories. He did these really good long- form stories. And so, he is telling Lee's story on Lee's account. This isn't even on his account. They were basically like, "Hey, come do what you do best. Talk about us and do it on our account." And this is the kind of thing where you would so rarely see a green screen creator like inside like a luxury thing like this. But they said, "Hey, we're going to put people in what they're best at and we're going to do it in a way that works in our brand world." And I have a lot of innate respect for that. I feel like a lot of brands who don't necessarily have a strategy, they don't know what they do, would be kind of wise to start with this. Say, "Hey, let's get 10, 15, 25 creators over the next few months and just put them in a position on our page to create something that is like what they do really well and let's see if that works for the audience. So that carries over and we can basically use their acumen to tell our story on

our media without necessarily paying that full price for the post on theirs or doing both. So anyway, I know we covered a lot within this, but I really do feel like this is a useful toolkit for centering a brand. This is not some like off-the-wall toolkit. It's not some big streetear toolkit you can only pull off if you're a fashion brand. This is really rooted in the basics of like amazing art direction, right? Having these recurring ideas, the way they have nature and fruit and their location and craft and product is sculpture. having these foundations of those repeatable things you do. The way that they're doing multiple campaigns a year with their still life and their editorial, making a set and also doing a yearly piece based around a place with a collaboration, having those recurring concepts, the way that they have that surrealism, displacement, negative space, art and sculpture, like humor and absurdity, having that world that's like defined that they can then build within and out and then having fun and taking it places unexpected in some what they've done on social media. So anyway, if you liked this, I have plenty other ones on the same playlist in this series. We've done, as I mentioned, Rick Owens. We've done Road. We've done Stuy. There are plenty uh more that are coming up that I have in the list. I'm going to do some category ones coming up. I think I'm going to do one on Quiet Wealth. I think I'm going to do one on kind of modern street wear. Still kind of prepping that. If you have any ideas, would love the comments below. Overall, I appreciate you so much for watching. Thank you. \[Music\]

Brand Social Media Has Changed (here are the cheat codes)

This is the new playbook for brands to win on social media in 2025\. And if you are creating on social media at all, if you advise or work for brands or work in marketing, if you have your own brand, it's kind of crucial to understand this. This is a version of a talk I give all the time at corporate off sites and in presentations and workshops I do with brands. So, I've refined this pretty regularly over time. And it goes through three things. the foundational content, what every brand should be doing like table stakes for modern brands on social and then it goes through growth social strategies that brands who are growing and executing well on social media are doing basically all of and then I'm going to go into the leading edge the 2025 modern strategies that brands who are on the fringe are executing on. Now, if you have a complete picture of this toolkit of all these things that brands are operating and doing and how they structure, you will know way more about social media than 99% of marketers. And that is my goal by the end of this video is for you to have a comprehensive understanding where you can shock people with how deep you are in terms of exactly what the strategies are that are working. So anyway, it's going to be an interesting ride. We'll have plenty of video and visual examples along the way and I am excited to lock in. First, I want to talk about the foundation. What should every brand have before they start thinking about doing more on social media? And so the first thing is owned social network presence on Instagram and Tik Tok. Instagram and Tik Tok have the highest leverage for any brand out there. Don't talk about LinkedIn, YouTube, X, any of these things until you have Tik Tok and Instagram. Why is this? Because of this amazing generational opportunity that is anytime you post a video on these networks, even if you're brand new, you're going to get 200 to 400 views automatically. It is going to give you a shot to roll the dice into virality. From video one on those accounts, you can get 10,000 views to a million views. And we see it again and again. And being able to leverage that opportunity which just did not exist like purely did not exist a decade ago is a immense thing that every brand should focus on. And so the foundational point is having the accounts on there but now it is basically table stakes to be approaching those networks differently to say we do not post the same content on Instagram as we do on

Tik Tok. We know that they are different. The algorithms are rewarded differently. We may use similar things or similar cuts but we actually treat those two differently. And the third part of the foundation is consistent use of influence inside content where personalities whether they have 10,000 followers or a million followers are contributing to your story on the internet and helping tell that through collaborative posts being a part of your actual on your profile or just calling out your brand. But that is what any brand who takes social media seriously starts with that as the foundation and everything else is extra. But that was the simple part. Let's dive into actual growth social. What does that mean? So when I define growth social and I update this presentation pretty frequently as like time goes on. I'm really looking at what were people doing really well last year that now everyone who's smart is adopting. So this is really the 2024 playbook now that we've had some time to actually look at it review it and see what has stayed consistent. So the first thing is creators as the face of brands putting a face to your social media content. This can be done in several ways. You'll see brands like Dar Shoots who have a handful of creators basically doing skits and you see the same recurring faces all the way to brands that have a creator making content relatively regularly inside their feed as the primary creator to people who have secondary accounts with other creators on them in addition to their main accounts. But you will notice that personalities have come into social media content. And basically every good account that is growing through that likely has a strategy where there is a creator involved. And this ties really well into this idea of founder personalities. And not every brand does this, but a lot have realized how critical it is. And you'll see they don't have to have the biggest personalities. To use that dare shoots example again, their founder is often present in the skits and the voice in his own videos. One fashion brand I love to call out with this is Perl. Perival will have the founder inside their videos like every 10 or so. He'll give an update on the business or he has like a cheeky perspective or he'll do one of the traditional and it's not the core of the content but it's part of it. And you'll see brands like Kosis where the founder is in collabs. She's building her own presence. It's not huge 30 40,000 but is a central character to a certain part of the brand marketing. And it doesn't always have to be a founder. It can just be a CTO or someone who's extra present. But there tends to be an employee who's helping drive a different focus on social media like tangential to the world that is driven by the core accounts. And with that, influence has graduated from hiring an influencer to do a single post into influencers in long-term relationships with brands where they have sponsorships where they're the faces where they do different content. You may have noticed I debut art list reports all the time. I have a long-standing relationship with them where I debut those reports. Same thing with Particle. I do videos with Particle every month. I'm a voice and a part of the Particle community. I've announced the last two Shopify editions. They have a relationship with me as a creator in a recurring capacity where it's interesting for my audience to hear about that, where people grow to expect it, where you are a character inside their story. Those long-term relationships are better for everyone. It's not just a sporadic one-off where you talk to your audience about it and forget it. It feels like it's developing real rapport. It makes you think and spend more time with the brand and be more conscious of it and actually be able to storytell about it better. And then everyone can look at consistency and realistic natures when it comes to kind of rates and relationships. And so that is the big personality drivers there is integrating creators and recruiting those creators into the core brand accounts having founder or team presences that are on there. And we'll talk about employee generated content in the like leading edge stuff later. And beginning to build influencers that are more like a team way we look at like a sponsored skate team back in the day. And this is something I've always been a huge fan of. When I

was doing a lot of work with Lift Foils, it is a a surf foil and e- foil brand. They always had a team, a bunch of sponsored people. We always had them in the same content. They were had other relationships like Brian Grub, who's one of those people who did that, had all these big deals with Red Bull. He's doing all these tricks. He's doing these things, but he also will be coming and doing tutorials inside our Lyft content. You could go explore that team. We highlighted them. It was part of our content planning was we know we could get X videos from this person, X videos from that person, and they're using our gear inside of the other content opportunities they're exploring. That's a really realistic and good way to think about growing influencer inside your social versus just paying for more and more one-off posts. But perhaps the biggest development in growth social last year was how big seeding has become like extensive product seating to influencers. Not just like sending a handful of products, sending a boat ton. I work with a brand sending up to 3,000 mailers out a month of products that aren't cheap. Inside one of my brands, we are sending dozens. And brands are realizing that just sending stuff out with no expectations and beginning to have those relationships and watching people post and knowing that creators need things to talk about as well becomes useful. And big brands are adopting as well. I got an ESOP package the other day which is something I never expect a brand of that caliber to be starting to seed especially to creators that are relatively fringe like myself. But that is where we've gotten on this is that they are thinking in terms of scale of that as well. And to do this I'm going to break down some management of this and how to do this well. We'll get briefly into tactics here before I go back high level. So usually how this works to do this well is there's a research portion of this. A lot of this research happens on Tik Tok or happens on tags on Instagram. Look at who tags the brand on Instagram. You can find it there. You search Tik Tok and you search review. You search the brand name. You will find hundreds typically for a brand. You do that throughout your category. You make a list. You do outreach to those people. And you're literally DMing them from a brand account or using an email. If you find an email to get an address to send them stuff. You are monitoring all this in a spreadsheet because there is no software that is actually good for this. There are some that try and then you are kind of noting, okay, did they receive the product? you're following up and they did receive it to see how it went and all that needs to follow a cadence. Did they actually post? You have to monitor because stories and stuff like that sometimes it can slip through. So matters to actually check in on these creators. You see if they actually engage, if they did engage, you're actually notating that so you know if they engage and you're beginning to build a list of people that actually post when you send them stuff. Then you're noting who has results because if you got a bunch of followers from something, this is why I encourage influencers to do feed posts a lot instead of stories is people can see more result from that and be like, "Hey, that got 10,000 views or 100,000 views." They're beginning to be interested in introducing those people into campaigns. And it's a graduation from I just hit them up and I gave them something, they didn't respond, all the way to, hey, this is now a person that we pay that's integrated in our workflow. And there is in this economy we have of creators, that's a whole different video, there is no shortage of people in whatever niche you are to do that. And the lift that comes from this in terms of, oh, that content did really well. Let me now run this in the Spark ad or white label this and pay them all the way to just seeing the natural sales lift is significant. And if it is not or you're not seeing content, there's probably things related to the unboxing experience or to the product itself that make it not warrant to have that jump. Now, the fifth of the six tactics in this growth social segment is the multi-account presence. You will see lots and lots of brands doing this is a smart way because you do one social account is not enough to take advantage of what's happening. So, you will see brands

will have accounts by region. So for instance, one thing we had done at gelb blaster I talked about a few times is we had accounts for Mexico accounts for Canada for Germany for UK specifically supporting those retailers and their initiatives when we were distributed globally and actual creators who make content in different languages or different accents around that. So regional is an approach a lot of brands do and you will get a creator in that region posting from that region with that account in that language or in that dialect doing things that are particular to that culture and it works really well. The second multi- account item is by style. So you will notice, hey, we actually have a more candid account or we have people that look different on different accounts. We have like in cosmetics, it's like, hey, we have girls with different complexion or different racial backgrounds or facial structure or eye types. That's important because people follow people that look like them and have similar problems and similar encounters in their life to them. Same thing in fashion. You will notice, I actually did a study for a major retailer for this where we were interviewing Gen Z people where they follow people that look like them and check what outfits they have from fashion influencers to then decide what they were going to wear. not necessarily to buy the product, but to say, "Oh, how am I going to style these like denim jeans or whatever it looks like?" And it's because they find people with their body type to see what looks good on them. And that is a whole subculture. So, styles of content and then types and looks of people. You will start to see brands will have 10 accounts, 15 accounts because the ripple effects of the internet are basically as big as you can possibly scale to. And the last piece, especially for physical products, is Tik Tok shop with affiliates. not just putting a Tik Tok shop up, seeding affiliates and beginning to run hundreds of people, getting to 40 videos a day, 100 videos a day, coming from affiliates to drive revenue in there. And this is a really important one to think about because of the lift of it. If you are not super familiar with Tik Tok shop, the basics of it are there are creators that run affiliate. That basically means that they can make money when they post and link a a product. You've already seen that. Now, they are in high demand. There are lots of those people out there, especially if you can actually drive some revenue. So, they are constantly gifted products. You have to have a program to reach out to them and get them to gift their products. Rarely are you going to have good creators actually request it. Now, none of these creators also get on retainers who actually paid a monthly basis to do x amount of videos for brands. And so, brands are constantly hunting those down. But what happens is with that commission, the Tik Tok shop sales coming in, you are still beating most retail margins. And there's a lot of scale to it. So, you'll notice the bigger brands that are operating at this who are doing a million a month or even hundreds of thousands a month, multi-million a month, are running so many affiliates and creators. There's so many videos about their products hitting at various degrees that it has a lift on Amazon has a lift for brand recognition. Can you imagine if by purely off commission you could incentivize commission and grit to be fair. You could have have hundreds of people every month posting about your brand on the internet that aren't influencers you pay. It is a majestic opportunity for brands and one that everyone is taking serious in this growth social lens. So now we get to the fun part, the leading edge. What are brands that are on the tip doing right now? What are the people that are standing out happening like as we speak, as I make this video in June 20 and 25? So, first, this idea of video series and brand TV. This is one of my favorite conversations cuz this is where you get all the people being like, "Oh, the budget. They need tens of thousands of dollars an episode." One dude or girl with a mirrorless camera or a fullframe or whatever it is can work absolute \[__ \] miracles. And if you are denying that, you do not know what you are talking about and you are going to get left behind by this era. I have seen shoots now that look like they're full production shoots

just literally a person shooting someone one way in a conversation then turning around and shooting it the other way with the same camera and like moving two lights and getting the same results you normally have a crew for. And this is where we're at with technology with the savvy of this younger generation of videographers and with the run and gun nature of brands making great content. But you'll see all these brands who are doing brand TV. Alexis Betar, probably the most prolific, who created the series that got so popular that like they have Lar Ro kind of crossing over into it and like minor celebrities inside of it all the way down to the lower production where you have Mohawk Chevrolet remaking the office inside of their car dealership. But basically, this is brands who are saying, "Hey, in addition to our normal social on those channels, we're going to have a recurring series every week or whatever it is where we are treating it like we're making TV." That is something a fringe groups are doing. Ritz Carlton did it recently. It's going from small brand to big brand and is a super savvy way to approach content because the reason this works is because we are in this consumption shift where people are just moving from TV and streaming to social increasingly and if they are doing streaming or watching TV they also have social on at the same time and by replicating formats that people know inside that social it works and it helps brands be more entertainment and less purely selling. The second thing probably the most talked about this year is clipping and distribution and services like \[__ \] So, what this means is you are hiring people, whether oneoff or are putting it out there to a community to clip videos, basically take your existing content archive and put them out on other accounts to gain additional distribution. This happens in two ways. One, you'd employ someone to actually make those clips and put them out there and play them a fat fee, maybe an incentive to say, "Hey, you're going to make these clips a month. You're going to post them on these accounts." Second is you do a bounty inside programs like Wap. We're like, "Here's a training. Here's our archive. We will pay you $2.50 per thousand views." I think that's what Goalie is paying right now. I can confirm it. I have it on here. That's exactly what they're paying right now. It's easier to do this for personal brands, right? That's why you see people like Bred Scales has a has a great channel. People you've seen do this and help them blow up. Druski has a channel. They're offering much less, but it's easier for you to be able to blow up doing that. And those bounties will rise over time. You can basically pay for views being circulated by people clipping content. The power of this is massive as well, cuz someone can feel like they're everywhere. And the algorithms are smart. And if you start to watch a Bre video, you see 14 other Bre accounts suddenly conquer over your timeline. It is a genius way to get faces out there that started with personal brand. This dates all the way back to the Tate era was the original playbook for this. It's now been kind of commodified and now is in the brand era where goalie's on the fringe. Goalie is one of the if you aren't familiar with them. They're a Tik Tok shop like hero story and they're leaning into more fringe stuff. We worked for them for Tik Tok shop and it was also like helped turn their company around from near bankruptcy and more brands are to follow if they have the right catalog and they fit the right mold. Then we're entering into long form on YouTube. YouTube is one of the hardest content types to break as a brand. You'll see brands that do it really well either have personalities to lead it. I'll call out Represent or I'll call out Minted New York because they're basically just documenting their founders working out and doing stuff around running a brand which is just compelling content for male consumers to just have on on the TV and has a great angle for it. But if you don't have those kind of personalities in your brands a little bit harder or you have basically just YouTubers who are starting brands or you have brands are treating YouTube like YouTube. \[__ \] being another good example of that where they're going and doing YouTube style long form videos about people with an aspirational

lifestyle who are on who are doing clipping etc. and kind of in that culture and telling amazing dynamic well-edited stories. But to do that on YouTube, you have to have a concept. You have to treat it like a show. It's not just making videos. You have to either act like a YouTuber or act like a show of content. And that is something that is really hard for brands to do. It's why you see so few on here with any level of resonance. But that is a huge opportunity for the ones that do. And one of the reasons I'm so focused on YouTube, you see these videos every week is there's still just a massive delta. It's so much harder than the other networks. And if you are the ones to succeed on it, you're owning a line share of the attention. Like not to cut y'all in on a secret out here, but like there's not many other marketing creators out there. There's not many other marketing creators getting these views. Most of the videos about marketing that get views are kind of older videos and sitting in the algorithm. I'm one of the only ones putting up those numbers, if not the only one doing like real B2B like that. And that has a monopoly over people's mind share that is like unassalable. And the longer you keep doing that and the farther ahead you are, the better it goes. And it's actually shocking to me how far ahead this is and how few people are competing to keep up. That's a separate video. Then we go into EGC. There's three more left in this leading edge category. So EGC is employee generated content. So we're in this era where Gen Z is deeper and deeper in the workforce. Gen Alpha is about to start coming in the workforce. And if it feels like half of Gen Z are creators, it's cuz it's probably true. There are so many people who are native to making content. It's natural for them to make content at their jobs. It's also natural for them to be on screen or want to be on screen or see where that takes them. So you'll have brands, Remy by Riley is a great example, where their employees are part of the content. The Remy by Rally account is funny because literally it's just employees doing trends and not even talking about the the product, but they're just like running content for fun basically. And this is a good model for brands to begin to inundate themselves into the culture to gain exposure to leverage the fact a lot of their employees want to be creators. Complicated in other ways in terms of how do you actually incentivize this or reward this or pay for this and what are people's work responsibilities but more and more brands are putting just separate employee channels or employees on Maine more and more frequently and then we enter into niche social for instance Snapchat still big for brands. NYX Cosmetics is a big Snapchat. If you are targeting Gen Alpha, Gen Z and you are not on there and you're a brand that is more consumer focused, like you need to hire some younger people to help you navigate that. And even Substack, so Rare Beauty just launched on Substack. A friend of Hyper, Casey Lewis, Hyperlet I had with Clayton. We've interviewed her a few times. An amazing Substacker is helping American Eagle do a Substack where they're looking at, hey, let's find some of these niche communities, smaller things. may not be worth our full social time, but if we're already good at all this other stuff, this is something we can lean into at a reasonable budget to find a more niche focus. Again, you only get to once you're at the leading edge. The way I like to break this down is you have to do the foundation, master everything in growth social, then get into things that are on the leading edge. And you will see there are teams once you start getting in the flow of this, it becomes much easier than than what it looks like here. And the last piece is the mass seeding affiliate and training. That's when you start talking about they're seating thousands of affiliates, thousands of influencers every week with new product. You're adding tons of affiliates on a Tik Tok shop, as many as you can. And then you are training. The step that goes beyond that is you're starting to recruit from your community. You're starting to find people who are trying to be influencers in your audience and coach them up to find people who aren't affiliates yet on Tik Tok, but make good videos about your product and making them into affiliates. This is the real edge is like

you're basically being we have to drag those people along with you. You can't wait for people to do it. You're better off recruiting them, bringing them into the light and having them stick with you is like the very very very leading edge of what's happening right now. That's the social landscape. That's what brands are doing. like every tier in capability. That's every one of those tactics, at least a brief summary. You will never find content as comprehensive about this this on the internet. Frankly, I charge a lot of money to do this in person. Basically, I don't think anyone who's actually done this in person will ever see this YouTube video cuz my audience here is much younger. But if they do, actually, the value goes into let's actually workshop this through everything your company's doing today. What's the status of each one of those? Which one of these is actually a priority? What are the steps to act on that? And even just the hour you spend on that has a massive value. And that's where I come in. But if you've ever wanted that comprehensive look at this, this is a great video for it. I will probably update this if this does well next year because these things naturally change. If you have any questions about these different content types and styles and things going on here, let me know. I'll either tackle in the comments or try to hit on another form of media. I appreciate y'all watching so much. I will link some other brand social content here, marketing content that's relevant. Thank you'all so much for watching. \[Music\]

Por qué las nuevas marcas parecen viejas ahora (manual de estrategias para marcas de lujo de 2025\)

This is how to successfully build a luxury brand. I'm using a case study on this concept of heritage maximalism. It's a widely used term, but one I actually made up on TikTok like 2 years ago. And we're in an interesting era where brands aren't trying to pop out and look brand new anymore. They're not yassifying, but instead they're trying to invent a brand identity and find a legacy that may or may not exist that makes them feel like they've been around forever. And you see this in fashion with brands like ALD doing their best Ralph Lauren impression. you couldn't tell if that brand is 30 years old, 50 years old, or 5 years old. You're also seeing the same thing in packaged goods. So, my friend Andrea at the snackshot had a recent post about this where she's actually calling out, I think she called it Nau Artal, which actually calling out some of the brands who are taking this strategy where they're saying, "Hey, we actually want to look like we've been around for 100 years inside our packaging with some really interesting examples of kind of how that's being merged into a combination of of modern aesthetics as well. This briska olive oil is a great example of like it's a full period piece. But in this video, I'm going to go through a whole variety of things. I'm going to talk about the state of aesthetics and the aesthetics that were like the millennial defining era into where we're at today and how we've moving from '90s nostalgia to like nightcore nostalgia. We talk about my recent trip to Paris and seeing how people are embracing some of these older aesthetics. We're going to dive deep into a brand called 1803 Bully who are the poster childs of basically creating a luxury house out of thin air and how they've done it and why I think it's a really interesting playbook for other brands to look at and replicate. I'm going to share some other examples from inside the food industry. We're going to talk about luxury toothpaste, how technology is embracing this new look and feel, and overall what the tools, ideas, and recipes are to make something seem like it's been around forever to help justify these higher price points, and what a holistic luxury experience looks like for a brand being built for the next decade. So, first, we lived in this era. If you're a millennial, you lived through this, if you're Gen Z, you may likely remember it, where all these new brands were coming out, and they were all being branded by these agencies like Jin

Lane and Red Antler to look like these new millennial brands. There was these cartoon characters, these very primary colors, these millennial pastels, very simple logos. Everything was becoming very millennial, for lack of a better term. And you'll recognize brand after brand that was basically done by these same handful of agencies who were just known for cranking out these like simple, successful millennial forward brands. And what we're seeing now is a reaction to that because many people were kind of taken advantage of by those brands. We've seen a lot of those brands go from darlings to bankrupt or had founder issues. There's a lot of kind of glorified issues that happened inside that era. And also just consumer taste switches over time. And none of those band brands positioned as luxury. They positioned in this middle tier where it said, "Hey, we're going to cost more than the traditional thing. We're going to look a little better. Our marketing is going to be a little bit better. We're not going to go up to the full era of luxury. We're going to charge a premium for our aesthetics." And what we found is that people don't want to buy the premium for those aesthetics purely anymore. or in fact they feel like they're kind of getting a raw deal for that and have been educated enough by the internet to understand it. They actually do want to feel like they are buying history, luxury, and an experience with what they get. This comes with a bigger idea, this shift into maximalism away from minimalism that a lot of brands should be super aware of where you'll see now the aspirational apartment isn't an ultra minimalist millennial. It has gold frames and splashes of color. The looks inside architectural digest have shifted. There's amorphous shapes. There's plants. Things are extra versus simple. And it was interesting. I went to Paris a few months ago. I made a handful of videos that went pretty viral. And one of them was just about the experiences you can do in in Paris if you are into maximalism. And one of the ones I called out was from this artist group, Ex Libras, who I stumbled into inside of a like these luxury pet stores I was around. Above them on one of the floors was basically like a little booth where they would make crests. They will like basically handdraw and come up with crests for you. And they have this business I'm scrolling through here where they have just have all these gorgeous like very intricate very traditional crests you can get like with a stamp for a fee from this group. And it was it went extremely popular like everyone was commenting and asking about them. They got a bunch of followers and inquiries and it was just a reminder of like what people are looking for when it comes to aesthetics which ties really much into where the foundation of luxury is today. That they want this kind of legacy look and approach. And I think this is in a large part due to how easy aesthetics have become to replicate, especially with AI where anything that's relatively modern or simple can be replicated very easily using all these basic tools that we are basically proliferated with how easy it is with creative market and a few stock assets and a little bit of chat GPT and midjourney to make any basic modern brand that people see so much of that and are inundated so much with that that really when they think of aspirational or something that they want something that represents them they want something that's handmade that has more care that is more intricate and something like exaborist is an amazing ability to go have that kind of level of experience onetoone with an artisan versus everything we deal with in this internet era and I bring this up because this is what I think the foundation of luxury looks like for these next decades is that it is really historicalbased even if you are creating something new the experience needs to be that craftsman focused that artisan that ornate in that way and I've talked about the pillars of luxury before talked about how luxury needs to last over time talked about how the quality needs to be there. The difference between something that's bespoke, something that's designer, and something that's luxury. Save that for another video. I'll link at the end. But in this video, I want to focus on that heritage maximalism aesthetic and how people can basically create a legacy brand

out of thin air. And to do that, I want to talk about Bully 1803 cuz they are someone who's done it. They are not a brand that has been around forever. This was a company formed in 2014, acquired by LVMH. It's a decade and change old that references an ancient brand that pulls on all the tropes you'd expect from a brand that has legacy in terms of how it presents itself, what the packaging looks like, what's on the website, the experience inside their stores, positions it very much as a brand from 1803, as well as it being in the name even though it is something new. And it's actually became quite controversial. There's a lawsuit out there from a perfumery or fragrance house that says that they took their imagery and use a lot of their imagery inside the intricate packaging that they present. As of me making this video or at least writing this, that remained unresolved. But the point is they have created a brand identity around positioning themselves as legacy and done it successfully cuz at the end of the day, the consumer doesn't really care what that actual history is there. They care about the quality of the product they're getting, the look and feel of what's happening. if they feel like they're buying into a movement, if they get the results, and if they can have the experience. We're going to go through those one by one. So, first is presentation. They have immaculately designed packaging in the most ornate levels possible in ways that is kind of even hard to comprehend how one goes about making something like that. These are mainly skin products and body products, but there is intricate illustration on essentially everything. There are labels that beget it to being an older time. Same thing with the ingredients, with everything about how this is positioned. There is at no point do you doubt for a second that they are not all in on this identity of some vintage luxury of this heritage maximalism idea and this carries through to the experience in store. If you go into the store is a time capsule intricate presentation and they have leveraged that to also provide an experience and this is one of the biggest things I think is crucial for any luxury branding being done in this modern era is if you want to take that shortcut to time you need to have this experience element. I'll call out ALD around this as well because part of what has cemented them was when they launched the ALD cafes which became a destination which had a look and feel which felt like luxury that are done better than the Ralph Lauren cafes that they are replicating in terms of design and experience and present them as a artisan thing you can go do even if you're not actually purchasing an ALD jacket you can go buy in on your ALD coffee and where Bully has done this in a genius perspective is when you go to Paris one of the most crowded experiences that you can do is to actually go get in any of those locations you can get engraved combs and brushes from them. It is an extremely popular thing to do. Is relatively affordable. It's like a €50, say 30 to 100 depending on the model that you choose. And you get it engraved there. You exit with an absolutely like ornate bag. The whole thing because the way the stores look and the way the brand looks and the experience in there is perfect for making video content. And you can buy your little piece of Paris as part of that experience, which is something everyone wants to do. They want to be able to have that video of going to a thing that's they know is going to look great on the internet. They want that memoir that's not like some random thing. It's a brush or something useful they'll have in their life dayto-day. And Bully nailed this by saying not only do we have this product lineup, this brand, this intricacy, we have this physical real life experience that is worth seeking out that becomes part of someone's plan inside their journey. much as stopping and getting a coffee when you are in the lees or wherever the ALD store is has become a part of the day of their target consumer or visitors into the city knowing they have a destination to go there. All right, so in this segment I'm going to talk about the email marketing that some of these heritage maximalist luxury brands do and I'm going to show you a bit inside of Omniscent, which is the email software I use for the brands I work with, how to actually set some of it up.

So this segment is sponsored by Omnisense, but as always, I don't want to just talk about a software. or I want to show you how to do something you can use in your career with it. So, first I'm going to start inside of Mil. Mil is a free tool that you can use to see brands email marketing. So, I'm going to pop in here and I'm going to look at Bully 1803 and the actual emails that they use. And one thing I want to call out and why I like to do this is you can see how Luxury actually does email. So, here, you know, beautiful title at the top, all the graphics we've talked about, but look at they're writing a novel inside of this email. There's so much text, there's history, there is context. This is kind of the opposite of the email marketing playbook a lot of brands do who say, "Hey, we're just have one graphic and a little button says call to action." They're literally educating you on all kinds of stuff. It is in French. As you can tell, I'm here in Europe. So, some of the default language is French and Italian on things I look up. But you can see inside here, we got like a whole history of Maria Antuinette going into a Victor Hugo quote, then going into them talking about their products. And so I just want to call this out to note that you should feel okay putting lore and history and thought into your email if you are a luxury brand. Now heading over into omniscent I want to talk about automations. So I'm going to go here to automation. I'm going to hit create workflow. A lot of people get I guess spooked by the concept of automations. Sounds like it's something that's really complicated but it's actually really easy and it's a core part of selling for your brand. So here they have a bunch of pre-built automations you can just click and get into. Something like a welcome automation which we'll talk about here. So automation has a few things you should know about. They have triggers, so based on something that people does, an action gets created. Then they have actions, so things like a delay or an AB test or splitting people by some parameters they have. And they have actual emails you can put in there. So, one of the things I love to do if a brand has no automation already is actually just go through their best performing emails, save them as a template, and then load them into a flow like this. I'm going to start a new flow to show you how. So, create from scratch. Define how a person enters a workflow. So, I'm put enter a segment. Segments are basically lists and portions of list inside of Omnisend. I can select that. I'm going select my pre-release segment I have inside this account just for relevancy. I can choose to trigger that workflow for people that already exist when I when I set it up or I can just have it for new people that come in. I'm just going to set this for new people that come in. And you'll see these actions. I'm going to delay pop in here. Also may want to tag them. So I say, "Hey, let's wait for 1 minute after they signed up before we send that email. I want to add them to a new tag." Pop that in there. And then I can put an email or an SMS. Literally, you're just dragging it. And then that email, I can either set that up right here. I can save this content. This will allow me when I go into edit content. I can actually go and I can change the template to any template I already have. So, I will save other emails as templates or usually set it up before I drop it in. Or you can just go custom design it. But then once I create this, I can do the same thing. I can delay again, say, hey, I want to delay this for another 2 days. I can drop in another email. I can do another delay. Hey, I want you to actually get this 7 days later. And that gives you the basics of how to put together a flow. So, what I will typically do here for a brand is I will have an auto email, not just like behind the brand, be like, "Hey, here's all our top performing videos. Here's our bestselling products and why. Here's frequently asked questions about styling or sizing or how it works kind of thrown in there with some content." And to the point of the bullet emails we looked at earlier, don't be afraid to like really go in depth about what makes your brand special inside of email. So, I'm doing all this inside of Omnisend. Omnisend is a great choice for brands who want to send email. It links direct to your Shopify. You can actually segment and send emails and tag and stuff based on what products people

purchase. It'll do your cart abandonment workflow and you can add more emails and triggers to that. You can do back in stock notifications and they do all this at a greater value. So, it has a cheaper cost overall for the amount of emails in your system than a lot of the popular alternative email marketing softwares. You can learn more about them in the link to Omnisend in my description. That is an affiliate link. So, if you do join or use them, then that helps me as well. hopefully learned a little bit about email automation and how it is not an intimidating thing to set up and just adds so much more value over time as you get subscribers to have them automatically being onboarded to your brand. Let's go. What's most interesting to me is this is based on a house, but they just took it, right? Whether the allegations of the lawsuit are real or not, they took an identity of something or created and fabricated an identity and made it their own. And we live in this worldbuilding time where you can do that. If you have the creative vision, you can actually come up with your own complete history of something. It's a fascinating exercise. and go fully into it. If you are a creative, I have seen no idea why you wouldn't want to do something like that and build something wholly interesting and immersive to that level with all the tools we have available today to be creative. Like that is a differentiator of kind of true luxury. I don't talk about some of those other videos is the ability to create something so magnificent that people are drawn to it, which is something they've done here. I feel like that's something every creative should be able to aspire to. And related, I want to talk about a chef. I think he's a French chef called Yanver. He has a store in Miami, but they've done like a light version of this where they have iconography. They have this fox, this kind of very like a playful, whimsical, very French-based identity, a former identity. And they've played it out extensively over their packaging and the different things that they have for their brand in terms of how they display everything, how intricate everything is, how everything feels like a long time historical bakery, even though it is kind of a new look from a French chef. A lot of this is in positioning, is in packaging, is in embracing that maximalist ideal. And if you uphold the standard, both of your product and of the cost that you sell it at and the premium there and the aesthetics that come with it, you over time can begin to establish yourself as to a feeling of a luxury. And the experience really adds a lot to that. The ability to go somewhere in person and experience it adds this degree that really works so well in the modern era where we all make content where people are looking for those like little relief and treats. It's why you see everything from Louis Vuitton cafes to Margella pop-ups. Why these luxury brands are leaning into this. They're almost going downstream and saying, "Hey, cool. You can go buy a cheaper thing from us at our Prada Flower pop-up." But if you are a new brand, you can go upstream into that same thing. That's a much cheaper and easier than opening massive stores. And one interesting tool, if you're a creative kind of diving a little bit more into this world, is this tool, Public Works. It's by the same team behind Cosmos where they've actually taken all this imagery that you can get from public domain and they've scanned all these like intricate libraries and they've put all this image where public domain basically means is past the trademark limitations where you can actually use it royalty-free and it's all like old school stuff of different ways. They have a searchable incredible database of things which I think can get people going down this rabbit hole of what these visual ideas look like. As you see I can kind of scroll around this page here. there is no limitation to how indepth that goes. And so I do feel like we have all of these tools here for people to create these much more intricate brands and experiences. And I feel like that's where it's going. If even if your brand's been around for four or five years, it needs to feel and look and have the intricacy of if it's been around for decades. That's the new differentiator for aesthetic versus like a sleek presentation. It's an interesting concept to think about if you care about luxury and its

positioning. And if you think it's vapid, so is any amount of buying luxury in the first place. This is more I actually really like and I'm into this because you are creating a world, you are creating lore, you're creating history, you're letting artistic expression go extremely far versus refining it into the particularities of like something modern, which I think is an interesting exercise and involves more interaction with artisans. It involves more interaction with history. It makes it more interesting by default, at least to me. We've seen this play out in any number of ways in terms of how brands are positioned over time. And one I always love to call out in a similar aesthetic is Marvis toothpaste where they position themselves as a more expensive higher quality but far more interesting. Just look at the experience of this website approach to toothpaste with the same heritage maximalism look that you see so much in kind of the examples that I've given that when you look at visual positioning how different things compare to each other. This is one I think every aesthetics driven person should understand. You have your kind of yassified product positioning. You have your minimalist product positioning, your millennial product positioning, your counterculture, your liquid deaths, your death wish, your extreme positioning, and then you also have now this kind of heritage maximal position. Any product or any shelf the products are sold on, there could be an angle to take this with it. And it's funny to see this even go over into technology where this is a little bit more of a kind of art deco grecian approach, but A16Z's recent rebrand where they have gone allin on golden coins and maximalism of a different kind is I think you will see that same ornate branding come to a very traditionally modernist tech as well. Anyway, I know this is a little bit different of an approach to how I do these like kind of more tactical luxury videos. I feel like this aesthetic is really important to talk about. It's one that's going to dominate for a while to come. It's an interesting playground to work within and something that everyone who's building a perspective of the luxury world and the aesthetic world should understand. So, I appreciate y'all watching and more videos I have here about luxury if you want to get more into the tactics of that. Thank you all so much. \[Music\]

The World Building Playbook for Creatives (Rick Owens Case Study)

Today we are going to go through the worldbuilding playbook for creatives. This is going to be a case study of Rick Owens. Rick Owens takes an approach to designing to creativity to his brand that is so unique and tasteful and beautiful and has broken through so many molds of what people would consider a brand to be. And the magic of this is he's created a world that whenever you interact with it, it's almost like it's alien. like you're not on Earth, you're transported somewhere else while still somehow being commercially approachable. So, I'm going to distill this into terms and frameworks that are applicable for any creative, whether you're an art direction, creative direction, a designer, have your own brand, or just looking to find your own visual style. And this won't do justice to a fraction of the world that Rick has created, but hopefully spark something beautiful in your vision of what you can do along the way. In this video, we're going to cover spectacle, trademarks that designers have, the product funnel, muses and characters, the designers as lore, aesthetics, creating their own worlds, how that all comes together into the world building of a brand. Let's lock in. I want to start with a goal. I feel like every creative or designer should have their own version of, and that's to build a world completely of your own vision. If you have aspirations that you want to be someone important in the visual or aesthetic field, you need to have an actual aesthetic ideal that when someone enters your space, whether it's your home or your retail store, goes to one of your shows, even sees the cars you drive, a party you throw, they're taken out of the common world and you merged into your world, into something that is unexpected, that

is completely designed and created to be an extension of your vision. And if you can build a world that's that big, where all these different creative ideas you have are pulled into the reality, then you are one of those like magnetic creatives as the ability to like shift the way we feel and understand and resonate with the world around us. And it's so intrinsically powerful. We've broken all of our creativity down now into design this web page, create this 30-secondond video, launch this like single capsule collection and less into these massive worlds that people like Rick Owens built. And I'm going to talk about the funnel of creative here because at the end of the day, this does tie back to commerce. I think many people who would have been artists in prior generations now are clothing designers, product designers, content creators. And so this is art and commerce kind of fully intertwined. And by that nature, these things have to make money. It's all going to come back to a funnel. What do I mean by a funnel? If you've watched any of my marketing videos, you know that kind of a top of funnel means you need things that draw attention, that get attention to your brand and your vision. Middle of funnel is about education, about nurturing, about turning people from just being aware of it into advocates of it. And then the bottom of funnel is what people actually convert. They buy, they become leads, they do the action that you're looking for. And all marketing comes down eventually to a funnel. And looking at a brand the same way is a really interesting proposition, particularly a brand like Rick Owens. So at the top of funnel for Rick is art and spectacle. I think he's one of the core kind of pioneers in this world we've seen of product as marketing, right? You can go on your social media feed nowadays and you can see a massive oversized bag being hauled around by someone like Fugazi or you can see some crazy product that was made purely to succeed on social media. Like I look at the Gentle Monster Bratz dolls, right? That is made to be a social media product. Now Rick has been doing this generationally, right? And whether it was art he created like tables of himself or inside the shows that they were doing where models were wearing each other as backpacks like down the runway. This is being created for one goal and that is to create art in the name of spectacle to bring awareness to the brand and world that he is creating. And many people who aren't deep in what are you going to buy from a fashion perspective only know Rick Owens from these crazy shows from all these visuals we're showing here on screen that are just wild things that people are asking who would ever wear this? What is the proportion of this? And all of this is just to gain awareness into the world that this brand and this identity exists. And in the modern era, this is increasingly important. And people do this in different ways. Shock Moose might do it in a cute and playful way. People might do it by having a founder or a key celebrity. But doing it from a pure artistic vision perspective. And then doing that as an entry point into a larger weird world that the brand has is something that I feel Rick has done an incredibly powerful job with. But then right below that in the middle of funnel, what actually brings people awareness? What makes it into a trademark? what becomes a thing that people are familiar with that they consume more of that they can start to see themselves doing that becomes that that middle of funnel territory of what the brand looks like and this is why trademarks are really important for brands has been a great example of this where you actually see these things in different ways come into the clothes that are uniquely and signaturely Rick the first is these shoulders that we'll show here this almost batwing style design that shows up on all this different clothing that when you see somebody wearing no matter what kind of celebrity they are you go maybe that's a Rick Owens piece He has taken shape one of the core things that goes into any fashion design or any product design and turned it into one of the signatures and you see as a through line between years and between collections. So you begin with that idea of spectacle we had. I'm drawing in attention and you bring that down to signature. What are these things that are

rememberable trademarks of the brand that when you see you begin to associate with and it becomes a signaler to people that know. If you go one step down, he also did this with strings and laces, both all the pants, the long strings that they have and the shorts, which became a very simple thing, but it was very connotative of the brand to then updating that and saying, "Hey, I'm actually doing these mega lace versions." And all the shoes and a bunch of the collaborations now feature these extremely complicated lace designs. And so, you begin to see trademarks emerge that are signature for a design. And what I like to call out about this is every designer has these, right? This is the the core thing that we do every season after season. and they'll have their things that are uniquely them. But doing them in such a visually impactful way that is so different from what else is out there, that is so separate that it can only really be from one designer is what separates making something that's good from making something that is really resonant. So going back to the start, we have our spectacle that brings in attention. We have our middle of funnel, the more trademark things that occur frequently that people are into. And then we'll have what I'm going to call the bottom of funnel here, which is what people most often choose to buy from the brand. And this is a really interesting concept I think every designer and every creator should think about is what is your take on entry-level products? What is your take on classics? This is something that's a foundation of the Rick Owens brand. Part of one of the reasons that he's a controversial designer and there'll be a bunch of people in the comments here being like Rick Owens is torched because there is so many takes on these known things. So if you were to look at footwear for instance, you can see the Rick Owens footwear and be like there's the Ramon which is a direct Rick Owens version of a Converse. There's the Geo Basket, which is their version of a Nike basketball shoe. And then also typical things like a short, a pant, a cargo pant. You will see he has his unique take on all of those. Some of them more inspired than others, but basically is crafted enough of a worldview to be able to have a take on them. That's really useful exercise for any creative. If someone was to hand you some Vans and say, "You have to make these uniquely yours. So unique that someone will be able to recognize that they are yours from your signatures." That's a good signaler on if you've developed a unique enough style for yourself. And then the same thing with a short or a pant, right? What are those signatures? Whether it's, you know, with Rick with the pod shorts, you have a drop crotch, you have those same strings then applied across others. It changes and moves over time, but they're able to take a signature style and apply it to any given item. And then this ends up being what the majority of people purchase because no matter what high fashion and spectacle you have, people buy in at the entry level. CDG isn't held together by the highest end fashion it does. It's held together by the Converse with the heart on them. All these brands succeed off of their entry-level products. And the more wide a swath and the more adoptable it is while still remaining a vision that also is basically a walking billboard for yourself, the more successful a brand world becomes, the more interesting and spectacle and things you can do on the top end. But that Rick Owens empire is an empire built on Ramon's shoes and pod shorts. And so I encourage any designer, any person working at a brand, this can be clothing or not, to be able to think about what are the things that are drawing in attention for me. And they may not even have to sell. Their idea is to bring in attention. What are the signatures that you have on a brand you can see recurring underneath it? And then what would your take on entry-level things be? Because more often than not, when you establish your own design world, you're going to be entering into your collaborations with Adidas or Nike or Vans or New Balance or Converse. And that's what questions you're going to have to be asked. They're actually going to provide pretty deep implications as to whether or not you're going

to be commercially viable. Does your world you've created translate into those more common items? But now, let's move away from products. Let's talk about characters in the world building story. If you've seen any of my brand strategy exercises, I always encourage brands to look at their content, to look at, and content I mean everything from lookbooks to website to social media to what you run in your advertisements to runway shows as a TV show, sets, characters, etc. And the characters that represent your brand tell you a lot about the brand. And Rick Owens has taken this world and basically continued to make almost an otherworldly segment. You could watch a Rick Owen show and you're watching essentially like a sci-fi horror concoction from a lot of the choice being the characters that are involved because to his in his own wording is a cast of freaks. The characters in the story in every one of these runway shows and the models they have on there are designed to take you out of the world of reality. Whether they are hyper beautiful or seem like some sort of fictional godlike character or whether they are repulsive and would make people think twice about what is happening there or is this person even real? Am I in a horror movie? Are they made up to look like that? And in one of my previous videos on a similar topic, we talked about Stucy and the idea of the homie lookbook and basically the opposite of this where they're saying, "Hey, our friends and collaborators and the people that we know and skate with and write graffiti with are the people that are in our lookbooks." This is a very popular strategy that Stui has had with the Stui tribe for decades that we see a lot of people and brands do now where the common person has become like a part of the brand story and it's an awesome way to feel community with your brand. Then there's the opposite approach. Let's take your brand and put you into a fantasy world. And that is what Rick does. And that is a difference between something that a brand that's a community and a brand that is art. And they can both resonate in their own ways, but the art one is the opportunity to really bring a design and artistic vision to life for people that have that vision more than any other way. And in a world of about blank and represent and ALD, having models and shoots that all look very similar and their knockoffs and spin-offs all having their own shoots even look more similar. The passion to hunt down the freaks of the world, to make them the stars of your show, to find the correct visualization of your brand that is completely unique or completely its own story, no matter what that may be, is increasingly powerful as the algorithms center more and more brands around looking the same. All right. So, if you've ever looked at brands like this and wonder how much do they actually sell and how are they tying all of their marketing together in one place, we're going to take a moment here to go through Particle, who I'm super excited to sponsored this video, and show you how their competitive analysis software works. So, starting here on a brand many of us know, you can actually go and click into all the best-selling products and see how much volume it is. So, for instance, in this last time period, they're selling 76 of this hat, 33 of this hoodie, 13 of this belt. You can go inside any of the companies that they have inside the database to actually check out what level of volume they're really doing. And this is great if you're planning a brand to see what a brand has done over time and to see what their current promotions look like. So for instance, if I go over here to Cole Buckton, I click over to the events tab, I can actually see a summary of what they launched and when that is basically auto put together by the Particle platform. And then over here on the assets page, I can actually see by this little note when they've updated their homepage, new meta ads that they've launched, Instagram posts that they've put together. And for a lot of brands, their email will be in here as well that you could look at. But homepage swaps will actually show you campaigns and other things that might be hard to dig up when you're looking for a brand competitively. You can look at the rate sold per day. You can look at the average discount, see if a brand is discounting. You can see when they

do their sales and when they have their peaks and valleys throughout the year. But say I need some email inspiration. I could go over here into represent. I could go down, I could select email, filter it, and it's actually going to show me a bunch of the recent email campaigns and the dates that they were done. The last thing I'll show you in here is there's also trends of what's actually rising in search over time you can look at to evaluate new products. I like to look at it on a two-year timeline so you can see seasonality because some products might just be popular because of the holidays. You can look and see things like bookshelves rising in macro level popularity. Balenciaga having a bit of a resurgence. Obviously they have brought some new talent and things have moved around and it will show you this by a combo of brands keywords and ideas. You can integrate your own search as well. So, if you're looking to understand more of what's happening in your niche, who's actually selling what, put things together by price or color as to what you could sell, and also evaluate some of the trends happening in e-commerce products, you should check out Particle at the link in the description of this video. Thank you so much to them for sponsoring. And that brings me to my next thought in the characters, which is this idea of the designer as lore. We have a generation of influencer designers. Sometimes they have a lifestyle involved with it, but they are telling their story of their brand as it comes together on the internet. And this is something that Rick is doing as well, but completely on his own terms. Because when you see content with him and it doesn't look like anyone else's content, maybe it's being shared by one of his muses, maybe it's on an account, but the music is weird, the ratios are off, things aren't made to look like other content in terms of how they succeed because a full world is built around it. And contrasting writing that completely unique world, that world around you versus being completely normal is a choice that people have to make. What do I mean by completely normal? I mean people are copying each other's content. You basically see a couple different classes of builders. You have like the workout influencer brand owner where it's like, hey, I design clothes. I have this brand and all my content is around doing those things and being fit. That is like bucket one and we have enough of that. Then we have bucket two, the people that are building their brand in public and sharing a lot along the way. And we have a lot of that too. Like I did all these vlogs and videos where I went to China and showed all these places where people make their brands and then this year there's like 40 people making the exact same videos, right? Then I go back, I make some of the same similar content. doesn't do as well because people are continuing to kind of distill these things that happened. And I feel like that same area is also just uniquely as as basically done as the as the first and there are plenty of people that do it amazingly, right? There's always going to be the first people like if you look at like George from represent, you look at Marcus from Minted, people that have done that influencer athlete like at a high level and continue to are, you know, they're the pinnacle of that. And you have a community built up underneath it that is just based off these same ideas isn't going to go as far. Same way with people that are sharing the blueprint as they go. But then what they're always just room for is someone doing it from a completely new artistic perspective based on their unique vision. And this is the hardest one, right? This is the one where you can't just go copy the same videos where you have to have original aesthetic ideas in your head that honestly a lot of people don't because it's extremely complicated. But hopefully this playbook begins to identify a bit of that world where you say like what is my spectacle? What are my visual motifs? And you'll see everything that Rick does from the naming of the runways and the collections to these set pieces they have on there where there's this these combinations of like ancient Egypt and you know far-off gods near sci-fi pieces of horror all this brought together and clashed into a world and I encourage people to

sit down and think of what does your world look like from that perspective because that's what the world needs right now. It needs more Ricks because the bar for that is higher. another brand owner sharing their workouts as part of how they build their brand is taking from the same market share of people interested in that one thing when there's a lot more people out there who are interested in other subcultures and ideas and who frankly are looking to be inspired because right now more and more people make content more things are on our feed it looks more and more the same it's harder to take apart and to be pulled from that which everyone wants everyone wants to be pulled out and find something that makes them feel something it has to be unique so now I'm going to talk about aesthetics and how they move through a world beyond simply like the core core category you're in because one of the important things that we've seen from Rick Owen's world is that it can move in how it collaborates and how it moves through different categories. So he is a recurring collaborator with Monontlair. They have all the Monontlair genius stuff with Rick spanned out from just clothing. It was easy enough to say what is his motifs of fur and oversize and logos and iconography laces. Let's apply that to cold weather gear. Easy enough to figure out popular in its own right. But then adding to that, moving into all these different realms, whether it's vehicles, whatever it is, and then seeing the same thing of like he develops his own system for interiors, the Glade system, and then having that then be Travis Scott's traveling studio is like a tech glade version of his architectural world. There's furniture that comes from that. It can all live off of these same things. That's the other piece to ask yourself as a designer. When you are going and playing in these different realms, what are those visual things and how do they actually translate? Do you care enough to submerse yourself into all these items in a way that makes you love and be interested and resonate inside of all that? And another designer who many of you know who's done a very good job building their world across things in a unique way without having it be as wild as Rick is Samuel Ross. What he did with a cold wall, what he's doing now with his own label, what he's done with his collaborations, where it's applying this more technical design world into all these areas that he touches. But the exercise for that for a designer now is if you begin to think of your motifs and your brand and your design begin to ask like how would I apply this to furniture? How would I apply this to a vehicle? What would those things look like? It begins to take you outside of that world you're in of just what am I going to make this t-shirt look like? What am I going to make this product look like? And begin to understand a world not just by the characters and the styles that are in it by but by its application and application to things that people use and engage with more so than the statement of what they wear. So anyway, I hope this video sparked some ideas and thought as to how you think about what you design and what your vision and potential could be like. And I would encourage you to go back and look at some of those exercises to be like, how would you approach or develop enough signatures to be able to design a pair of Vans that people recognize them as your own? To be able to apply your visual world, what do those characters look like? What do those muses look like? To be able to have your own unique content style, to be able to say, "Hey, when I make furniture, it would look like that." and beginning to open your creative mind a bit more to what those worlds look like than surely into that world of short form content or the things we're kind of boxed into. Now, it feels a really useful exercise for any creative. Now, I would just encourage you to also not have any restrictions in your vision of if you really have an interesting aesthetic idea or an idea of what the world could be like this is now the time to be able to create it. We have the ability to bring visuals to life cheaper and easier than ever to put content on the internet to see things resonate to make any product in any category. If you have the strongest of visions or the most unique of ideas, you are in the best generation

in the history of the world to be able to do that, bring it to life, monetize it, create something interesting that resonates with people. And I would encourage you very, very highly to actually go do that. That was my guy. Like I mentioned, I'm not beginning to touch on the full world of Rick Owens and do justice to all the things he's created, but hopefully spark some ideas to what you can do yourselves. Thank you all so much for watching. Please like, subscribe, all the above, and I will be back next week. \[Music\]

How to create a brand vibe people f*ck with

in today's video we're going to talk about how to make a brand aesthetic that people actually like and how to World build around your brand visually and tie it all together in a modern way I'm going to be sharing my workflow in milanote for my brand and for client projects and this is actually really important because a lot of creatives are visual thinkers but they don't have the right visual tools and until I got this workflow here where as you can see where I can go look at boards at a high level and scroll through everything that I have going on visually and like watch the ti end and make notes about it I was like stuck in a workflow that didn't work but we will start with putting the inspiration together visually behind a collection we will go into building out a brand theme we'll talk about individual shoots we'll talk about your social content we'll talk about Bridging the Gap between Collections and then we'll talk about building like a visual world as a designer That's goes beyond maybe what you do just with a brand but what you do across projects since I work on all so we're going to start here inside uh my studio board and one of the most important things that goes into any pre-br process is putting the mood boards together for it so as you can see here these are the boards that were initially behind my valuable brand there's many call outs that many of you will be like very obviously seen and I put together like that summary of of items and item ideas that I wanted to have in there graphic and graphic ideas and some kind of like lifestyle and themed overlays that I can could go back to that from the start anytime I want to create a visual I would go back and be like does it play inside this world and you'll notice it's not a huge board Maybe 50 images on here probably less but they tie into a couple recurring themes and anyone should be able to scroll through the kind of board the way you scroll through the board here and have a general visual understanding of what you're trying to do with the brand and you'll see I would kind of Now navigate that into what I'm actually creating so next to it I would put individual briefs of things that I'm working on right so I'm working on these duffel bags I'm about to release here in a few months and then from the start I kind of had these overlapping items if you look over at the board to look at the bags we have his references it makes complete sense you can see visually how one ties the other same thing with the briefs I had for several products and all the kind of references we put together all the way to some of the tech packs of the initial stuff whenever you kind of have a visual display like this you should be able to kind of see how things work together that it all makes sense inside of one world and with that usually comes a list of iconography right like when I put together that initial board Eagles snakes leather kind of car logos was the initial thing that tied that world into what we wanted it to be this is where I really encourage people to find and lean into Aesthetics that work where you'll see Brands always is a Y2K brand this is an opium Brand This is a western brand this this Western world is one that I'm familiar with as many of you probably know I've worked for five or six years with a a women's wear Western brand where we've created a world around like a very particular look and feel and so this visual identity obviously much more men's focus a little more Street Wear Focus was very familiar to me but a lot of these General ideas you want to look at from aesthetic perspective

you have to look at who is it actually appealing to and as the ability to create something different and so what do I mean by that I mean that you see all these Brands pop up or it's the same logos the same iconography the same rough designs played out in a slightly different color way or with a different logo and with the way social media is now you can get some popularity you can even get to your sixf figureure drop by doing that but it doesn't give you that same longevity that understanding patterns understanding materials that building out a story and something unique for a demographic does and so I want to anchor because I had this familiarity with the Western World building I want to Anchor inside an opening that I saw where I was basically like hey there is certain guys in certain places that enjoy this SP who have been introduced to more fashionable clothing into a more fashion forward life into Street Wear by the Internet by the Tik tokers that look like them to help them style themselves buy some of these accounts and Instagrams who begin to kind of purchase more heavily but there isn't really a brand that speaks to them they may be rude which is kind of way too expensive and feels way more Street Wear there's kind of like the Vintage era that's hard for people to actually go find and hunt down and I was like all right I think I can create a world around that and more importantly I could create utility products around that cuzz I went and looked at things like these bags and was like there's just not the right product for people's lives that exists out there there's some good brands but they're not they don't have that same aesthetic feeling of what's like modern and popular today that's why I centered the thesis around some of my first designs on then tying that into the same utility of hey a car is a natural extension of someone's style and personality how about we create some products for that right think about the areas with which this goes to go beyond apparel and clothing and map that all out like inside of these initial boards one thing to understand to be uh and lean on is that your initial Concepts aren't necessarily what you roll with forever right there's there's the concepts you have there's the applications of the concepts and there's what customers actually think ultimately what sells and then what you want to do and I've been working through all of that and there's basically no content that talks about this on the internet cuz designers often really private about it I'm going to walk through that whole experience so working on a photo shoot is an extension of that I like to work side by side board to board on those so this is a photo shoot uh I have a video about the photo shoot I do with Garrett king um where we did these kind of like Heist themed shots uh with models for one of the latest campaign releases uh and this is the mood board for it we kind of mapped out where again I want this to live in the same visual universe as this but to be more cinematic more shoot focused I feel like it's important to have those different boards because you begin to be able to feel this idea of like fire incorporated into it of motion incorporated into it of the vehicle being the star of every one of these feeling like they're a frame from a movie as opposed to a photo um like of a model right when we began to put the shoot together we began to have this as what we like uncovered behind it and same thing with even the colors we had in the shoot and the colors this was like the the clothing colors that are in there I'm really pulling um hexes and pantones and putting them up here so we can see kind of what works visually in the same place I can look at these Side by Side and being like this shoot feels like an extension of this brand story and then I come down here into my actual assets and the things actually came of that and so this was like directly inspired by what's above same here and ties into some of the assets that we'd run before I'm trying to make sure the storytelling and the visual world is the same I'm literally embedding Instagram post in my Mill note here so I can see how they work together right cuz this this whole night of the Covenant idea was for our Black Friday sale it's kind of like cormic mcarthy Bas which is like the brand voice and it lives in the same visual world as these even though they're shot

by different people the look is a little bit different it feels right you can see the colors have shifted across this well same thing here different shoot but the cover ties it together something with that other shoot we're beginning to add the video game element to it but I inside these boards I'm saying okay here's excerpts from social media here's excerpts from the white background shots and the model shots here's other shots I haven't got yet from this shoot and that shoot that I going to have here and then start to think about okay what's missing what ties together like this really warm light here I need that warm light on these before I release them to be able to kind of make these visually make more sense together you know I basically outlining all these assets into one place to see how things move and how things navigate and adding design Styles in that too like as we began adding designs for carousels Etc this is a different feel I'm beginning to explore for the future I kind of have that shift happening inside these boards and so that's worth noting and exploring as well is what happens between these moments of these Brands so right now I'm going through a shift in this brand World building where I found some success from some of these initial products inside of some kind of specific niches I found some success in meta ads I found some things that didn't work or sell as well I'm beginning to look towards the future I'm also thinking from myself as a designer what do I want to build and this is probably a video in its own right but there's this whole idea of like luxury pricing and the end of luxury pricing and something I really want to position against is like you can go buy $800 shorts and shirts and whatever um but there's so few people who can actually do that but more and more Brands pricing there I want to be able to deliver you know certain level of quality in in this mid-range I feel like it's going to be a bigger category but with that as I began to build the Brand Story it actually felt like At the beginning I went almost too under luxury for this where the things I truly aspire to build and create where my design talents are do Li higher end instead of trying to create a story that almost like lives too much in the middle and so I'm thinking as I get into you know ready for uh this next release I'm putting out this next month and then I get ready prepping for summer what does a transition look like from what I started with from what I validated what I've sold to where it's actually going and that's where we enter into this shoot that we have here and into this kind of summer collection so I'm getting ready to uh release for summer we've designed bags for it I have a bunch of kind of samples something like newer things coming redoing some of my popular items like these Beach pants I have I've kind of put together a board that I feel like lives in a similar visual world but is elevating it a bit is moving it a bit more towards Summer where I want to be able to connect the dots between the more vintage Beach feel and the more vintage race feel and like have it make sense and then in the middle here I have the shoot that we're about to do where I want to bridge the gap between what we did in this last shoot and getting to this next World while I release so much of these prodcts s and this is again the power of having all this next to each other is you can begin to see what all this looks like because I'm tying all of this together right cuz like over here at the same time I'm also configuring my visual world right so right now you see me recording here in front of this this setup here has no visual tie into to what I do with my brand um and I'm also at the same time redoing my house as a creative space and I want that to have a visual tie into the brand so I'm actually literally laying out in the moodboard what our plan is for my home to be like okay where does that overlap can I shoot content for the brand and inside that can these stories kind of align and the answer is like they don't really yet but that's the things that you're able to hack out on a board because what there isn't just enough conversation about is you have your brand story you have your individual shoots you have where your brand wants to go then you have the environments you created whether that's with photographers or Studios or your office space or where you

shoot as a Creator and eventually I want all of these to kind of be synonymous so one of my goals this year is to have my brand not feel fully separate which it basically is now have it feel more aligned with where I am as a Creator since I'm a a very primary driver of it so all this happens like here inside this space and then ties into what we're doing with product like I'm working through these new duffles here this is one of the duffles I did for format I'm looking at the colorways and where that kind of plays in I'm looking at these products like as they get released and the colorways and things that look there and how that could work on it and I'm literally tying the releases and what those look like to what I'm thinking about for my space to what I'm thinking about for like the future and one of the directions I have for the future I'm outlining here where as I think about where the products go I want to leave these initial colorways right where you saw hey it's red it's cream and I want to build into these greens these Blues I want to build into more technical garments I want to build into more bags and accessories into more texture inside of the clothes now that I see that there's a positive response to that and having this mapped out this far where this is basically fall next year ideally I'd be mapped into early 26 but we're not because the brand is like new and still finding its Groove like all that's happening like here inside these boards so I'm G to talk talk a bit about how I did this in Milano now I'm actually going to show some of like the garments that are tying this together and then I'm going to talk about my client workflows on the client story inside this as well so as you've seen throughout this video I use mote to organize my brand workflow and they graciously agreed to partner on this video and so every project I do has a master board like I'm showing you here basically my brand Universe where I can visually look at everything going on and like track the workflow and make sure it's cohesive so what I think I haven't showed so far is like this corner here where I have everything from like a very simple to-do list to like the core creative brief we have to some tech pack links to where things are in terms of production and like a list of the incoming items is all happening inside the same sheet that the visual universe is again I I have the smaller versions of my mood boards we share notes about the project in here I these color call outs about the color stories and how they evolve they actually just let you pick a hex and they'll do these color code ones which is a little thing I love but you can also create sub boards and offshoots so when I talk about client projects like I do a lot of product design for client projects as well so one of them that I'm working on right now I have a subboard in here because there is just a lot of overlap I'm using the same designers I work on the same team on it it's often the same photographers it operates in a like a Associated visual world when I do a client project there's another one that is kind of popping up here um for like a sub brand all this I'm just happens in the same board so I can easily jump beneath them and then those subbs I can share them separately if they're going like direct to a client or a different team without having them see the masterboard um but I love this as a platform because I can embed these social posts like this is here like literally I just copied an Instagram link and was able to embed it whether that's publish work or references that we have and this is the exact type of organization that works for my creativity I need to see everything and milanote is the app to do that in you can get started with them at the link that I have down below below and Millan note is available for free with no time limit popping back into this I want to talk about some of the items that are coming out and how those tie into this kind of visual world that's being created and I want to talk about some client projects so one of the through lines I had for this brand from the start is texture I care a lot about texture and material for anyone that's experienced the shirts or gotten some of the things that I sell you'll notice that everything is just a level above in terms of like texture and material quality of anything else similar that you've gotten because of my expertise kind of in supply chain but as I shift towards this

future mood board you see here you'll notice everything has very intense colorways textures looks and technicality and I'm beginning to bridge the gap in between the in between where I am now and where that is going with this next release so this is one of the first products this is a a textured cargo pant and if you saw the videos where I went sourcing fabric overseas this is a material we actually found on uh on the trip where I went to Wong Joo it is a Japanese material is 100% cotton it's almost feels like a like a heavy denim but a little bit more flexible that we found while on that trip and that's how I build that story out right is I'll find these materials I want to make part of the brand and then bring them into this work but the same thing you can see some of the Branded bags that we do is we found that in multiple colors and so we have that same pant coming out in black as well they begin to have this more of a material story that matches the future of where I'm going with the brand while also still having iconography that can Bridge there and then it's releasing with this shirt um which changes slightly had a lot of people request to do unistress shirts even and though we sell well on the distress shirts I understand that again my audience as a Creator is much broader than my audience for the brand I'm trying to increase some of that appeal with what this works like here and so if people don't want to say hey I can't wear something that's that distressed I want to give them some options we're releasing just one blue distress shirt to see what people think of it and again it's the same iconography it's the same feels one of the same designs on the back that the cowboy have released in like the previous so the line feels like it has a bit of cohesion but you begin to see the change of what's happening in the colors like in the materials like in the Silhouettes from this initial kind of very American driven to a bit of where I'm going and then same thing with the evolution of the shoes as well where I'm moving into that similar color base you can see obviously the color of the shoes and the shirt matches it's going more into the blue and the blue and green I eventually plan to have it's incorporating some of the same iconography but it's upgrading the material significantly from the first shoe we did which is much more casual to this which is significantly more Lux but it's this combination of having my visual universe together of identifying all these shoots and where they are in the storyline of knowing really far where I want to go and then overlaying the sales data and the customer data on top of this that's getting me to where I want to go I know this is a process right like I mentioned we've been working on the women's wear brand now it's like five or six years to get it to where we want to be where it's a a really consistent brand and on that like I'm very focused on the ad and like email like funnel and sales like on that brand so I'm very much in the what products sell what are the assets that sell them and I think it's going to take an equally long journey as what I'm doing here but now at least have more background and expertise inside of understanding from the data like what does this mean what should we test kind of what works well together now let's talk about client projects too because all of this is you know while this is a brand this is a a extension of of my creator work of my creativity something I'm trying to create it's a overlap between my identity and work I still design for a lot of other people and I still work on a lot of other projects and all of those things when you begin to think of yourself as a creative as a designer as a personality like have an impact and how they tie together is important to think of your work holistically because I want people eventually to be like see something and be like hey was that Orin and when we did the firmont drap people were like immediately were like hey did you do this because they knew the things that I like and enjoy and the quality of some of the stuff and the look of some of the hoodies and the washes I've mentioned they begin to see the iconography ties into stuff that makes sense visually for me and so I've renamed some of this and moved it around just because I want everyone seeing things like the exact workflow here but you can see this is the mood board for a project I'm doing like

another merchandise project and it fits in the same world but there's some differences right where like I don't do anything in like Chrome or silver or anything like that that's going to live inside this Brand's universe but you can feel the iconography and the garments and everything tie back in reference to the brand that's how I thought about one of the through lines of me as a designer to with with Brands is that like the f bag was so good cuz I've been working on a duffel bag and I was like hey I'm just going to take this thing we've been working on do a version of it on a client project while I continue to work on it for my brand and I view like all these Silhouettes and things I've created like if I work with a client and they want to run a version of this cargo pant and a different material like great that's a silhouette I've developed I know it works they get something they already like and it helps my brand Universe tie things together similar to this like this is a a a new brand concept we're I'm researching right colorways all out there doing something more female focused looking at bags you have kind of the inspiration here looking at a lot of like older Chrome hearts and Chrome Hearts bags where again this fits very naturally into the visual Universe I'm in now but it's an extension in a very different way than where the current brand is going but being able to keep these boards and these associations and these iconography like inside of one project and easily reference okay here's what I have going on with these other projects here's where the core line is going does something feel really off does it make sense does it have to make sense like that's a bit of of how like aesthetic World building I think people should be spending time on and so if you're a designer I know you're designing and if you're you're a brand CER I you have all these things happening but having this in one visual place like is absolutely crucial and then overlaying it like if I can recommend one thing having gone through this a number of times and in the middle of it now is like overlaying that sales data like on top of all of this and one of the big new initiatives that uh we just kicked off a few days ago is I have a someone who's just dedicated to experience like on the brand Team who is emailing every customer of our first like our first thousand customers basically to be like hey this is like our starter group that really believed in us to like feedback that and to get early feedback on the things that are happening and to be able to tie that Community closer together to what's actually happening and have that not purely be online on social media because some of those connections are better directly cuz some of the customers are bu aren't going to be in your comments aren't going to be responding to it and I do feel like Aesthetics and result and where Brands go needs to be more driven Now by conversation because of how saturated everything is so anyway I know we covered a lot of Concepts inside this video I really just want to show this kind of like higher level thinking of how brand visuals tie together of how to think about products and generations of things of finding your particular aesthetic I and it's going to the actual intricacies of brand building more than you just print these t-shirts and run these Facebook ads because when I look at like the future of this at least for me is I whether this is just an extension of my creativity or whether this grows into something bigger than that like I want it to be around generationally I want to be something that is a a part of my life for decades if not forever and to do that like having intention from like Moment One insert how you build your visual world I think is more crucial than ever so thank you very much for watching did you want to try out Millan note it is below uh this stuff is all coming out the next few weeks it's all on a boat and uh if you want to be early for that just get on the email list we will go email list first on every single release and make sure people there have the chance to purchase before we do mainstream release and that's at valuable studios.com thank you all so much for watching

Oren Stussy Dirección de arte 03 25 FINAL

all right so today we are a bit outside of our normal environment we are here in London I'm en route to Paris I'm actually giving a talk tomorrow here in London about art Direction and social content I want to take some of my art Direction thoughts I've been preparing for this and then give youall a really interesting case study of one of my favorite Brands Stuy so in some of my previous art Direction videos we covered the core of what art direction is we've gone in depth into how you can apply some of its Concepts to things like a white background shoot but in this video I want to use Stu's pretty incredible canvas of all their various ads and campaigns over the years talk about a couple crucial Concepts that any art director or any brand making art directed content should think about we're going to cover text and treatments and building the iconography of your brand into art direction we're going to talk about using your logo as a core portion of how your brand comes across visually we're going to talk about the lifestyle of a brand and how that extends into art direction we're going to talk about the people of your brand the original stucy and the rise of what influencers call the homie lookbook and then we're going to talk about developing Brands signatures and through lines and using them over time all with tons of examples let's lock in so first why Stuy so as many of you know I actually grew up in Hawaii in Honolulu and the first shirt that I ever got was actually the stucy and I remember being in the surf shops with all the brands you'd think of quicksilver bong Etc but there was something about this brand and the designs and what was around it that was just immediately special was the first thing I'd ever bought with my own money that was like a fashion piece and it's crazy seeing that brand still today like here on the Streets of London you'll see the logos like like all around all the way to where I live in Orange County which is now where the stui office is and seeing a brand that has maintained its cool like throughout that time it's had some dips and erors but the fact it's been able to go there and survive from when I got that first t-shirt 20 years ago to today is a pretty incredible run but also you'll see their content permeate mood boards throughout all those arrows because they are a campaign first brand when you really look at Stu's marketing it comes down to the product itself and who wears it and it comes down to visual photo art directed campaigns that were run as ads and magazines that are now put out across their social media and into the kind of network of blogs and news that we put out but really every single thing at the core of its marketing they do very little else besides put out incredible art directed shoots and it's funny where I live now in Orange County in Santa Ana Stuy has an archive store it's one of the best pieces of marketing and kind of like secret lore I feel like a company can have where you go to this old downtown like Arts area there's not a tongue going down on there but it's like buring for where we are and they have stuff from stucy collections for the last decade they basically like slowly roll out things from anywhere from 10 years ago to 5 years ago to a year or so ago you can basically access a very careful collection of things that would otherwise be sold out online in like a tiny shop in this you know really fun area and seeing a brand that's so intentional about its access about its art is something I feel like a lot of Brands whether fashion or not can learn a lot from and aspire to be like let's get into some of these campaigns I'm going to start with this Birkenstock campaign stui does extensive collaborations and are always anchored in art Direction and this campaign in particular they are doing a lot of hedge trimming gardening all with their logo and iconography at the center and this is a great way to talk about iconography as a centerpiece for art Direction and why your iconography matters as a brand let's look at it this way say you have iconography for your brand it goes on your t-shirts Etc Great that's step one but when you're able to permeate that into what you actually put inside the concepts of your campaigns you're taking it to another level so in this Birkenstock campaign you can see

they have Hedges trimmed to look like the Stuy eightball to look like some of their key iconography and when you think about art Direction your team sits down and come up with a campaign and you have a concept saying hey we want to work with gardening we want to be able to do something on a beach want to do X and Y usually you're basically throwing on the board people you have access to and locations you have access to now when you have a really strong iconography set all of a sudden this becomes much more inherently ownable as a brand so for instance duy can go okay on this you know in the selection of people we have maybe for this shoot we could either get a fire eater or we could go work in this garden with someone who has Immaculate ability to cut various trees they say okay let's now apply our iconography to that they can cut the trees into whatever but if that's actually our c aall that becomes a much more interesting visual thing immediately conative of the brand and this is something you'll see they've done through generations I highly encourage any brand with iconography to do and if you don't have iconography how can you begin to develop those symbols that go with it obviously they've been around long enough to be associated with kind of legendary versions of these but when you begin thinking about your iconography you want to think the same way and a brand I think has run this Playbook really well is this brand 2js I believe it's from Spain where you'll see they will have their kind of logo iconography and they'll be running it like in huge metal sculpture it'll be on fire in the desert and they're kind of taking that same Playbook applied to their iconography this ties really well into this next segment which is building the cult of your logo we've talked so much about art Direction and just like making interesting photos making content that will stand out and this video really hinges on like how do you incorporate your brand correctly how does branding really tie into what you do from an art Direction perspective so there's this iconic shot of the stucy logo in treatment in a sunburn and you see it has multiple variations of their logo and iconography I also love this shot which is a drone shot of the stucy logo basically mapped in the sand on a beach and in our era now people will be asking oh is this AI is this CGI but like you know that this is the kind of brand that will go and actually execute this kind of thing we actually create a real sunburn we'll actually employ an artist to do this from the air on a beach it's part of the lore of the brand that these are things that are real and if you're in this kind of time now and you want to do that same thing you now have the ability to add behind the scenes content that helps tell that story and show the depths with which you're willing to take your brand lore but you'll notice that front and center inside not all these campaigns but plenty of them is that logo and iconography even this awesome campaign we'll get to the people and the people of stucy in a minute when they're playing dominoes they're spelling out the Stuy s and this is tied over into print for them for decades so st's most recognizable initial art Direction was they would take these shots lifestyle shots of people in their Community often in black and white and they'd have the hand styles of the kind of graffiti roots of the brand that would be all around in a border and eventually those would turn into just kind of like additions on the page but you're basically building a toolkit from there if you look at your Brand's toolkit you go we have iconography and then we have typography in this case you know with with the graffiti tie and they have pretty extensive typography they can use with it and then you have the actual logo itself like that is a visual toolkit for post application and something like this is interesting when done over time and especially this isn't just like a cool type treatment it ties into the lifestyle and culture that the brand was embracing as well but that becomes your basically visual like postprocessing toolkit or toolkit of what you can incorporate into the shoot and no one has done that better than what Stuy has next we're going to talk about the lifestyle tie in and we're going to get into people so stui started as a surf brand with a significant amount of like hip-hop skate Associated Roots but really has that Association of

lagona beach of places like Hawaii where I grew up and they've built that pretty significantly into the FI of the brand but they've done it with like the wideness of any action sport right one of the most iconic shoots they've done was this racing shoot with their branded car with the helmet coming coming out of it with the motion that's happened and they've embraced that action throughout their kind of brand history and this is when we talk about when we say lifestyle adjacent there's a lot of Brands now whose lifestyle is basically being fashionable or being street wear but was was important to think about suy as adjacent to basically anything action related any Motorsport any kind of surf sport that has the right connotation for them they've shown within these campaigns it's often not some like big sponsored writer or famous person either it's just people partaking in the activity but it's that sense of motion it's that sense of action it's an extension of the lifestyle and again when you have your art Direction toolkit as a brand you now have okay here's my iconography how could we incorporate that who we have access to okay and here's our lifestyle we're looking for an idea for a shoot we're action adjacent all right we want to make sure we can incorporate Motocross or racing like that now is all things when you look at the board you begin to have you've honed in on the choices that you have you can make interesting decisions within all right so in these videos I don't want to just give case studies I want to actually show you what actionable work with some of these same Concepts look like for someone like me day-to-day so I use milillo to organize my creative workflow Mill node is a tool for Creative organization and it graciously agreed to partner on this video so I'm going to show you how I use my art Direction Master boards like this one you see here inside Mill note so I do a lot of work in multi categories Cosmetics apparel consumer package KS I have one master board for each and I'll do what I did here anytime I take a project and want to present it or talk about it with the team so this is a bunch of Concepts I've pulled from my various boards and put into one now how is this different from a mood board and what makes this workflow special so inside Millan note here what I will do is I will take between three and let's say eight or nine images or videos and I can embed Instagram and Tik Tok in here one of my favorite things about mm I will put them in these big boards each one of these Concepts will have a title it will have a couple example shots I don't want to go too far I don't want a whole mood board I just want to be able to visually show an idea so anyone can look at it and be like okay I get what you're going for and then I will note about what would make this special or ideas that I have so for instance like this same kind of lap shot style but we use an ultra wide to show more of the surroundings or we have a series where there's dogs and cats on the lap as well or odd pets going down to these vending machine shots I have't note about how much it costs and how long it would take to actually get a custom vending machine I have some of these shot ideas for reels like a person buying it or shaking it to get it out or some models tipping it over or a day in the life of someone restocking like an oddball like a Cosmetics vending machine then what I will do is in presentations and in brainstorm sessions we actually go through a bunch of these ideas sometimes it's just a handful sometimes it can be like 20 or 30 to gauge what people like and don't like add some notes on here and I can literally just grab a note and drag it on screen and be able to put notes while conversations are happening and then what I'll do is I'll take everything that people like from the brainstorm session I will make a new board and I'll put those in there we can collaborate on that one add comments people can begin to add their own imagery and really take advantage of the power of a creative tool like mill note so if you're looking for an exercise you can do for art Direction ideas for your brand or to get the creative Wheels spinning for your own work I would suggest making a lot of these little idea boards so basically taking a masterboard getting three or four images that attached to a concept think

about how you can make it different and just laying a lot of those out so you begin to have a framework you can go back to because too often we'll have those visual ideas not put them anywhere and then forget about them and this is a really useful form format you can do to quickly review your own workflow or to go through something with a team so you can sign up for mote for free with no time limit at the link down below highly recommend it it's a tool I use every day now I want to talk about the stucy tribe and how that ties to this idea of the homey lookbook that's really popular now so from the beginning stusy has taken portraits of people in their Community they were known as the tribe early and it's funny I actually worked with someone from that like original stusy team a previous brand I worked out who would talk about like the Heyday of like those people and being invited to it and being like a member of that Community is like like a really awesome part of his life and something has continued now where you see that inside all these campaigns whether it's collaboration or not they're featuring these interesting people and people that are significantly real and was that something like when they did their campaign with Dre van noton where they have like flea from Red Hot Chili Peppers like in his element you know showing like the photos of that to various artists that they've been connected to over time to just the models they have there is an integration of people that are in a very real sense throughout the brand but the the real the hey this is part of our community these are the people we know is like an extremely important concept cuz you've seen this now from Al who shot with all their like friends and family out inside New York City to people like Brigade in New York who have all their kind of friends the center pieces of their campaigns there's this really important concept of replacing models with just people you know with real people because how closes fit on models isn't how closes fit on actual consumers and the same thing goes for how Cosmetics look on people or really any of the aspects like if you put some piece of furniture inside a gorgeous home that's a significantly different than what's reality and and consumers Embrace reality more and those stories tend to be more real and stusy from the beginning was showing hey these are the people inside our community the people that we mess with and by extension you can look at that as a community you basically buying into by buying into the brand and I would encourage Brands now to really think about that too and it's not just hey I'm going to use my friends in my photos versus like employing a real model it's more of is there a story that we can tell underneath that because that becomes the more interest of the art Direction before I came here to London I was in New York and we talk to the team from Brigade and they would be having this conversation like oh well my friend does this really interesting thing uh and so actually designed a piece of clothing they kind of inspired by that we want to do a lookbook around this really interesting thing he does it wasn't just like hey I wanted to put Carl in the lookbook cuz he looks a certain way it had to do with his story and the things that like Inspire them and do that that's a really great way as a brand to again look at that toolkit cuz now when you say I have my iconography I have this lifestyle Jason 2 now I have all these people that are coming in and out of my life that maybe their stories can hinge into the art direction of the campaigns that we're trying to do and now your world is starting to build out if you're kind of cataloging that on a whiteboard or a notion dock or whatever it is you're really beginning to build so companies are World building by taking all this together like what we're talking about here is really like World building for a brand and how art Direction plays into that and I think every brand should have you know its range of people that are a part of that Universe they're building and understand the power of the portrait of those people what is their angle going back to Brigade they have a series where it's like medium format photos of basically all their friends but theyve Incorporated the portrait idea like into their brand sty had this original idea hey we're going to have photos of people like out and about together

and then we're going to have our handstyle design around it and they're going to be black and white right there's very different approaches they have I'd encourage you to think for the people that you know that are engaged with your brand what is that kind of portrait what is that style you can Embrace over time to Showcase those people and there could obviously be more than one or you can do any campaigns another way I do think an important part is how you're capturing the people your community and incorporating that into your content so next I'm going to walk through some of the concepts as Stu's used that are recurring themes in their content and then we're going to go summarize all this into a playbook for kind of brand art Direction so one of the other themes you've seen deep within what Stu's done is surrealism so they'll do things like incorporating this dinosaur into the shots and you'll notice again iconography like the eightball logo is the back of this tire wheel cover but for a significant amount of time there was a like kind of Oddball dinosaur inside a number of of these campaigns right it's kind of thing where if you're flipping through a magazine if you're stoned in whatever era that was it's like oh like sick dinosaur like they are kind of incorporating this like thing that makes everything seem just a little bit more strange and that's a great theme and I think Brands all need a couple of these themes they can go into and back to and recurring things they don't have to be serious what I like about this is there's a lot of really serious stucy shoots there's a lot of really community-driven ones and there's just this like fun era that like again doesn't match perfectly didn't last forever but like was a a part of the brand and showed it you its other side then they have this other segment they have of like Urban action and people and who is wearing the brand and showcasing that from these like Street side shots of like this girl flicking off the camera in New York to these guys playing dominoes which I feel like is one of the most iconic Stuy shoots of like recent memory but what you're doing with shoots like these is you are showing people that aspire to be in these places or look like this like who wears the brand who they are adjacent to when they wear it and you're creating that story and again it's not models that's why I think this is really important and how to think in art Direction where you can think in art Direction terms of what what story does a model tell but you can also think of what does this scene and setting and people like in a location tell and for brands that are from a place or want to Aspire be related to a place things is a really important concept to have as you think about shoots and the last is the car signature you'll notice that in so many of these shoots do uses vehicles and there's a lot of brands that use vehicles in one way or another but they basically use them for framing like this shot that goes like through a car door or someone sitting in the truck bed or this entire campaign they did where there's really interesting cars on either side you actually can't even see the full amount you kind have to wonder oh I think that's a whatever or I think this is this vehicle you actually get the whole picture it makes you want to learn more about the shoot it it's like a really engaging way but they're basically using it like not as a primary not as this photo is cool because it has a car but as a a set in setting that brings depth into what they're are directing so if you now look at this whole toolkit that we described this surrealism this capturing of like the friends and community and the family these like Urban settings this idea of like the vehicles and then their iconography that's kind of stretched across not all but many of these the treatments of their logos and the handstyles on top of them that is their art Direction world every campaign you see from them operates Within These boundaries and with these through lines and if all this is on a board and you are a brand preparing for to doing campaigns you have a really solid sandbox with which you're able to play in and so your job as an art director when you're working with some somebody is to basically outline this sandbox like what are these things and your job as a brand is to be able to have a world where you actually created this so to run that back into a

Playbook like the first thing I think about is what is your iconography and how can it last like for my brand I have this really big V that's almost you know it's almost a check mark you know it has that like you the idea was hey let's let's you create something we could make big we could fabricate then same thing with like you know the folders and this archives idea and you've seen it complex con I had like a massive folder and there's like some of these kind of ideas of like archives and like the archival or design Department Focus brand that's how I'm kind of thinking about that is how can I build that iconography into many things and the second thing is are you building logo worship right are you making your logo a centerpiece that makes people want to have it on them and this is hard because for a lot of people when you really look at your logo you may not have that and you may not have that ability also to be easily integrated into campaigns or or easily kind of like put on it and like the treatments might not be there it it makes you really think about what your iconography looks like and the power of it then there's what lifestyles are you adjacent to right now think about this with my brand where I'm working with Garrett who's like a rodeo photographer aspiring Rodeo photographer and the connections to kind of that world for the brand same thing for the like the Ultra Car Enthusiast like mine's not just like any car it's people that he say hey I'm going to take this time and dedication and money out of my life to be the guy with a '90s Ferrari to be the person who's restored like X or Y like some of these adjacent pieces that you begin to to put together and like making gear that is exciting for those folks like so I I sell car mats at valuable and like car accessories right and the people that get them are the people who have like this project car or this thing that they're really proud of or got that you know hey I went and got this specific thing and now I want to have my person personalization on it they want to have that like attachment to it they'll go grab the car mats and like you'll see it like time and time again the people that end up getting it are people either like with this really specific vehicle they aspired to have or who are like have a project they've undertook where this kind of adds another layer of depth and lore to that project and then what is your portrait philosophy you're going to have all these people around you whether it's your customers your community whatever how are you capturing them what is your photo and art Direction style for that is worthwhile exercise to think about and then last what are those additional themes what are those recurring things that are going to be able to kind of work through that for example in my brand I do some of these like storytelling carousels it's like captions where they're almost movie like there like a recurring theme where I can connect things together this kind of like Heist almost like intelligent crime adjacent thing that can kind of continually perpetuate we're adding this other visual layer on of like you can always think about okay if we have a horse there's something that like immediately ties the brand into it by just being in all these traditional Street Wear scenarios or working with an existing photographer art director in their look but immediately we kind of added this like equ factor it's like an interesting idea I'm playing with but this is a what you can learn from the Stuy brand from their execution and the last point I'll note is that the campaigns are Relentless every single thing they do there's a thought through ART directed campaign every release every collaboration every season without fail and it's something that where people say hey maybe this time we're just doing the standard lookbook or whatever like they never do that it just always something that has intention and I think that's the same level what you should be bringing to your brand and how art directors should be thinking and laying out their ideas so I appreciate yall watching I'm excited to see what this inspires for you and your Brands let's go h